

Guidelines for the preparation of reports by Member States
on the application of the 1960 Convention and Recommendation
against Discrimination in Education

Preparation of the 11th Consultation

Combating discrimination in education

Eleventh consultation of Member States on the application of the Convention and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) (2024-2025)

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

1. Introduction

The Convention against Discrimination in Education (“the Convention”) and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (“the Recommendation”), adopted by UNESCO’s General Conference in 1960, are aligned with UNESCO’s constitutional mandate to “advance the ideal of equality of educational opportunities without regard to race, sex or any distinctions, economic or social”. The Convention is the first legally binding international instrument focused on the **right to education** and the only one exclusively dedicated to it.

The right to education is one of the key principles underpinning the Education 2030 agenda and Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4) adopted by the international community in 2015. SDG 4 seeks to ensure the full enjoyment of the right to education as fundamental to achieving sustainable development. Its scope captures the multidimensional nature of the right to education.

Representing a powerful tool to advance SDG 4 by ensuring effective articulation between normative and operational work, the Convention has been recognized as a cornerstone of Education 2030 agenda.

The present Guidelines are intended to assist Member States in the preparation of country reports on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation in the context of the 11th consultation.

2. Scope of the Consultation

Considering the Education 2030 agenda, the monitoring of the Convention and the Recommendation is of crucial importance to ensure an education that is truly inclusive for all and to counter persistent inequalities in access, participation and learning outcomes at all levels, particularly for the most vulnerable groups. This is particularly true under the current context in which countries are making efforts to recover from the learning disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. Concrete measures taken by countries in accordance with their legal obligations under these instruments contribute to implementing the Education 2030 agenda.

As the scope and content of the legal obligations under the right to education are aligned with the 10 targets of SDG 4, efforts are being made to ensure that the components of the targets are included in the guidelines and that these guidelines serve as a valuable contribution to monitoring progress towards SDG 4 targets.

Beyond SDG 4, the Convention is also closely aligned with the normative content on the right to education of other international human rights instruments such as the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966), Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women (1979), the Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989) and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006).

In addition, this Consultation is an opportunity to inform the ongoing **UNESCO Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education within a lifelong learning perspective**¹ (launched in December 2021). The Initiative investigates how the right to education could be reinforced placing it within a lifelong learning perspective and in light of the new demands being placed on education. This Initiative builds on the **Report from the International Commission on the Futures of Education**², which suggests to broaden our understanding of the right to education to clearly apply it to all ages and across all times and spaces. The initiative is also in-line with the **Vision Statement of the United Nations Secretary General on Transforming Education**³, and the **Report on the 2022 Transforming Education Summit**⁴ which call for the transformation of education systems to ‘include everyone, regardless of circumstance, context or background’. The Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education aims to open a collaborative and participatory discussion about the international framework to ensure the effective enforcement of the right to education and learning throughout life for all. Finally, the Initiative builds on recent inter-governmental dialogues, including the Marrakech Framework for Action for Adult Learning and Education⁵ and the Tashkent Declaration on Early Childhood Care and Education.⁶

It is also important to note that previous consultations on the Convention and Recommendation revealed that countries now understand the right to education in an extended manner. The 11th consultation builds on the findings of the previous national reports to include various areas that have direct repercussions on the right to education such as, for instance, digital learning, climate considerations, lifelong learning entitlement, and the role of non-state actors in education.

3. Reporting obligations

There are differences in the legal nature of the obligations under the Convention, as distinguished from those under the Recommendation. The Convention has binding force and the States Parties are under the obligation to incorporate its provisions into their domestic frameworks. The Recommendation, non-binding in nature, has political and moral force. Its adoption sought to take into account the difficulties that certain States might experience in ratifying the Convention, in particular with respect to their federal structure.

Bearing in mind the differences in legal scope inherent to the nature of these two categories of instruments, the content of the Recommendation is identical to that of the Convention. Member States are expected to give effect to it in national legislation and education policies.

The reporting obligation under the provisions of Article VII of the Convention and of the Recommendation is the same. Article VIII of UNESCO’s Constitution states that “*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization, at such times and in such manner as shall be determined by the General Conference, reports on the laws, regulations and statistics relating to its educational, scientific and cultural institutions and activities, and on the action taken upon the recommendations*

¹ <https://www.unesco.org/en/right-education/evolving>

² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379707>

³ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/2022/09/sg_vision_statement_on_transforming_education.pdf

⁴ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/report_on_the_2022_transforming_education_summit.pdf

⁵ [Marrakech Framework for Action | Institute for Lifelong Learning \(unesco.org\)](#)

⁶ [Tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022.pdf \(unesco.org\)](#)

and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4". Therefore, even if a country is not a State Party to the Convention, it needs to submit a report on the implementation of the Recommendation, which means that **all UNESCO Member States are expected to submit a national report** on the implementation of these instruments in the context of monitoring consultations.

4. Participation in consultations

The reporting period for the 11th consultation on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation covers four years (2021-2024).

The Futures of Education Report calls for a new social contract for education, which requires to understand education as a common good and a shared societal endeavour. To ensure this, extensive consultations involving a broad range of stakeholders is needed. The reporting process therefore needs to be **participatory**. This includes ensuring cooperation between ministries of education and other ministries dealing with aspects of the right to education as well as consulting social partners and **civil society organizations** and other relevant bodies.

The preparation of national reports provides a **good opportunity** for Member States to assess the implementation of the right to education in their country, identify specific challenges, build constructive dialogue with other actors involved in this field and share good practices.

In the preparation of reports, Member States are encouraged to provide **substantive and relevant information in a concise manner**. In addition to a description of the constitutional, legislative, administrative, and policy framework established for the implementation of the provisions guaranteed by the instruments, the information supplied by Member States should demonstrate how legal norms and practices comply with the Convention and the Recommendation.

Relevant information supplied for other reporting instances may be reproduced or referred to with precise indication as to its retrieval. Similarly, hyperlinks to any useful documents or relevant legal and policy texts are most welcome and texts can also be added in the annex.

Country reports submitted for previous consultations can be found on the **Observatory on the right to education**⁷ in the monitoring section of the country profile. The information provided in the reports are valuable both for the Observatory on the right to education as well as for **HerAtlas**⁸, the online monitoring tool for girls' and women's right to education. Information and data regarding countries' education systems are also available through the UNESCO Institute for Statistics database⁹. Beyond monitoring purposes, the consultation findings and reports inform broader work - serving for knowledge generation, advocacy, and technical cooperation.

5. Modalities and structure

The Guidelines are structured around three chapters:

- The **first chapter** covers general information on adherence to the Convention.
- The **second chapter** aims to gather information on the implementation of the Convention and Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4. As the most extensive part of the Guidelines, this chapter covers: inclusion and non-discrimination in education

⁷ <http://www.unesco.org/education/edurights/index.php?action=home&lng=en>

⁸ <https://en.unesco.org/education/girls-women-rights>

⁹ [UIS Statistics \(unesco.org\)](http://uis.unesco.org)

(section 1), all levels and forms of education (section 2), quality education provision and learning environment (section 3) and finally, strengthening governance systems (section 4).

- The **third chapter** seeks to obtain information on the methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments.

With a view to simplify the Guidelines while providing necessary substantive information to assist Member States in the preparation of responses, through a participatory process, **two types of guidance** are provided:

- (1) Open-ended and closed-ended questions to be directly filled in by Member States. Please note that multiple answers may be provided where relevant.
- (2) Additional information aimed at guiding Members States to structure and detail their responses to the open-ended questions (including remarks on how to respond efficiently to the questions raised). These elements are presented in italics.

GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: **UZBEKISTAN**

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report: **National Center of the Republic of Uzbekistan for Human Rights, Ministry of School and Preschool Education of the Republic of Uzbekistan, Ministry of Higher Education, Science and Innovations of the Republic of Uzbekistan.**

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I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education¹⁰

- Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

☒ YES

☐ No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

☐ Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country and whether assistance is needed:

☐ There is interest but no concrete action has been taken

☐ The ratification process has been initiated

☐ The ratification process is close to completion

- Please briefly explain the steps that have been taken and timeline when relevant, any difficulties encountered (legal, institutional, political or practical) in completing the ratification process. And how UNESCO can assist:

☐ No, not considering ratification. Please explain why:

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law?

☒ YES ☐ No

The international treaties of Uzbekistan, together with the generally recognized principles and norms of international law, form an integral part of Uzbekistan's legal system.

Constitution of the Republic of Uzbekistan (adopted on May 1, 2023);

Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On Education” (adopted on September 23, 2020 No. ZRU-637);

Law “On Preschool Education and Upbringing”, 2019.

- Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education?¹¹

☒ No

☐ Yes: Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence.

Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the right to education.

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II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

For reference: This section relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality of educational opportunity as laid out in Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation.

It further corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all” by 2030. While it covers all the SDG4 targets, it also specifically covers SDG target 4.5.¹²

- Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

¹¹ Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.

¹² Which calls on states to “eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

☒ Yes ☐ No

- If yes, please provide reference:

In Uzbekistan, education and upbringing have been declared the key to sustainable development. In 2019-2022 alone, preschool enrolment increased from 46.6% to 70.0% and the number of preschool educational institutions increased from 5,211 to 27,609 (SDG 4). The reforms have been highly praised by UNESCO. According to the New Uzbekistan Strategy, the goal is to increase preschool enrolment to 80% by 2026.

Young people's access to higher education has significantly increased. While in 2016 only slightly more than nine percent of secondary education graduates became students, by 2023 this figure had increased by 3.5 times. As of the beginning of the 2022/2023 academic year, the number of students enrolled in 191 higher education institutions operating in Uzbekistan exceeded one million. The share of men among students amounted to 544,800, and the number of girls - 495,600.

In 2017-2022, the number of higher education institutions increased from 77 to 199, and the quota of admission to higher education institutions was increased fourfold to 38 percent. Targeted work is underway to improve the quality of the educational system at all levels. It should be noted that additional opportunities have been created for the education of young women and girls. Since 2021, separate grants have been allocated annually for more than 3,000 girls. A new system has been introduced for allocating funds from the State budget to banks to finance educational loans on preferential terms for women to study on a fee and contract basis in higher education institutions.

All of the above measures have contributed to the development of the country's education system (SDG 4).

A particularly positive trend is the increase in enrolment of girls in preschool education, which until 2019, traditionally, as at all levels of education, was lower than the enrolment of boys. Active promotion of private sector involvement in the system and growth in the number of family preschool educational institutions contributed to the increase in enrolment, including children from low-income families, in preschool education.



1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education

- Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation¹³, and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply):

For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b¹⁴

☒ Legal texts¹⁵ prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education:

☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

☒ In primary education

☒ In secondary education

☒ In technical and vocational education and training

☒ In higher education

☒ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

Citizens' access to education, regardless of their nationality, is guaranteed by the Constitution, the Education Act, the Preschool Education and Upbringing Act and other legal and regulatory instruments. Under article 4 of the Education Act, the basic principles of education are: recognition of the priority of education; freedom to choose the form of education; inadmissibility of discrimination in education; provision of equal opportunities for education; and introduction of national and universal values in education and upbringing.

In the Republic of Karakalpakstan, in order to increase the level of enrolment in higher education, the Councils of Ministers and provincial administrations, together with the Ministry of Higher Education, have established in each province, by 1 September 2021, public organizations and systems of education and upbringing in the mother tongue of ethnic groups. In accordance with article 33 of the Education Act and article 6 of the State Language Act, the right of persons living in the Republic of Karakalpakstan to freely choose the language of instruction is being realized

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:

Article 4. The basic principles in the field of education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

Article 4. The basic principles in the field of education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

The basic principles in the field of education are as follows:

¹³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

¹⁴ Which calls on states to "substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes".

¹⁵ Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.

recognition of priority of education;
freedom to choose the form of education;
inadmissibility of discrimination in the field of education;
ensuring equal opportunities for education;
incorporation of national and universal values into education and upbringing;
the humanistic and democratic nature of education and upbringing;
continuity and consistency of education;
the obligation of eleven years of education and the preparation of children aged six to seven years for general secondary education;
the openness of education for all within the framework of state educational standards and state education requirements;
the unity and differentiation of approaches in selecting educational programs;
lifelong education for individuals;
guaranteed social protection of teachers in society;
the secular nature of education system;
encouragement of knowledge, ability, and talent;
harmony between state and public governance in the education system;
openness and transparency in the field of educational activities.

Article 5. Right to education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

Everyone is guaranteed equal rights to education, regardless of gender, race, nationality, language, religion, beliefs, social origin, or social status.

The right to education includes:

The development of educational institutions;

supporting innovative activities in educational institutions and implementing curricula using innovative technologies;

organizing education both in separate forms (daytime) and non-separate forms (correspondence, evening, remote) from production;

the training, retraining, and advanced training of personnel;

the right to receive free general secondary, secondary vocational, and primary professional education;

providing citizens who have been educated in family settings or through self-education, as well as those who have not completed general secondary education, the right to undergo certification through an external examination process at accredited state educational institutions.

Foreign citizens have the right to receive education in the Republic of Uzbekistan in accordance with international treaties and the legislation of the Republic of Uzbekistan.

Persons without citizenship who are permanently residing in the Republic of Uzbekistan have the same rights to education as citizens of Uzbekistan.

Foreign citizens have the right to study in the Republic of Uzbekistan in accordance with the international agreements and legislation of the Republic of Uzbekistan.

Stateless persons permanently living in the Republic of Uzbekistan have equal rights to education with citizens of the Republic of Uzbekistan.

Chapter 2: System, types and forms of education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

Article 7: Types of education

Types of education are:

preschool education and upbringing;

general secondary and specialized secondary education;
vocational education;
higher education;
postgraduate education;
retraining and advanced training of personnel;
extracurricular education.

Article 8: Preschool education and upbringing, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

Pre-school education and upbringing is a type of education aimed at the education and upbringing of children, their intellectual, spiritual, moral, ethical, aesthetic and physical development, as well as the preparation of children for general secondary education. Preschool education and upbringing also provides for the compulsory one-year preparation of children aged six to seven for primary education. The procedure for the organization of preschool education and upbringing is determined by this Act and the Preschool Education and Upbringing Act.

Article 9: General secondary and specialized secondary education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

General secondary and specialized secondary education is aimed at mastering general education curricula, necessary knowledge, skills and abilities.

The stages of general secondary education (I - XI grades) are:

elementary education (I - IV grades);

Basic secondary education (grades V to IX);

Secondary education (X - XI grades).

Children are admitted to the first grade of a general secondary educational organization in the year of their seventh birthday.

Primary education is aimed at forming in students the basics of literacy, knowledge, skills and abilities necessary for continuing general secondary education.

Basic secondary education provides students with the necessary knowledge, skills and abilities in accordance with the curriculum and develops independent thinking and analytical abilities.

Within the framework of basic secondary education (after grade VII), vocational diagnosis and orientation measures are taken to provide students with primary knowledge and skills in the professions.

Secondary education ensures that students acquire the necessary knowledge, skills and abilities in accordance with the curriculum, as well as the choice of further education and mastery of professions that do not require high qualifications.

The order of organization of professional diagnostics and orientation, as well as training of students to professions that do not require high qualification, is established by the legislation.

General secondary education shall be carried out in general secondary educational organizations continuously for a mandatory period of eleven years.

Secondary specialized education shall be carried out for two years on the basis of nine years of basic secondary education in academic lyceums and shall provide accelerated development of intellectual abilities, as well as in-depth, differentiated, professionally and personally oriented education of students.

See previous edition.

Non-state general secondary educational organizations shall organize their activities on the basis of a license in accordance with the state educational standard.

(Article 9 was supplemented with part eleven by the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan

of September 7, 2024, No. ZRU-957 - National Legislation Database, 09.09.2024, No. 03/24/957/0689)

General secondary and specialized secondary education in non-State educational organizations may be provided on a fee and contract basis.

Presidential, creative and other specialized schools and boarding schools may be established to develop the abilities of gifted and talented children.

Children with physical, intellectual, sensory (sensory) or mental disabilities, as well as children in need of long-term treatment, receive education in State specialized educational institutions, general secondary and secondary special educational organizations in an inclusive manner or individually at home.

The number of students in classes (groups) of general secondary and secondary special educational organizations shall not exceed thirty-five.

Article 10. Vocational education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

Vocational education in the acquired profession and specialty shall include the following levels:

initial vocational education;

Secondary vocational education;

specialized secondary vocational education.

Primary vocational education is carried out in vocational schools on the basis of graduates of IX classes on the basis of two-year integrated curricula of general education subjects and subjects of specialties on a full-time basis on a free of charge basis.

Secondary vocational education is carried out in colleges on the basis of general secondary, specialized secondary and primary vocational education on day, evening and correspondence forms of education lasting up to two years, based on the complexity of professions and specialties on the basis of the state order or paid contract.

Specialized secondary vocational education is carried out in technical schools on the basis of general secondary, specialized secondary, primary vocational and secondary vocational education on day, evening and correspondence forms of education lasting not less than two years, based on the complexity of professions and specialties on the basis of a state order or paid contract.

Citizens who have received specialized secondary and vocational education (nine-year general secondary and three-year specialized secondary and vocational education) prior to the entry into force of this Law shall also have the right to receive secondary and vocational education in day, evening and secondary vocational forms of education for a period of less than two years, based on the complexity of professions and specialties on the basis of a state order or paid contract.

Citizens who received specialized secondary vocational education (nine-year general secondary and three-year specialized secondary vocational education) before the entry into force of this Law also have the right to receive secondary vocational and secondary specialized vocational education.

Vocational schools, colleges and technical schools ensure that students receive their chosen profession and specialty.

Citizens have the right to receive a second and subsequent vocational education on a contractual basis.

Article 11. Higher education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

Higher education provides training of highly qualified personnel in the areas of bachelor's degree education and specialties of master's degree.

Training of personnel with higher education shall be carried out in higher educational organizations (universities, academies, institutes, higher schools). Persons who have general secondary education (eleven years of education), specialized secondary education (nine-year basic secondary and two-year specialized secondary education), initial vocational education (nine-year basic secondary and two-year initial vocational education), as well as persons who have received specialized secondary, vocational education (nine-year general secondary and three-year specialized secondary, vocational education) before the entry into force of this Law have the right to receive higher education.

Higher education has two stages - bachelor's and master's degrees.

Bachelor's degree is a basic higher education, providing in-depth knowledge, skills and abilities in one of the directions of higher education, with the duration of study not less than three years.

Master's degree is a higher education in a specific specialty on the basis of the corresponding Bachelor's degree with the duration of study of at least one year.

See previous edition.

The list of specialties of Master's degree and corresponding to them directions of Bachelor's degree education shall be determined by the authorized republican body of executive power in the field of education.

(part six of Article 11 as amended by the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated September 7, 2024 No. ZRU-957 — National Database of Legislation, 09.09.2024, No. 03/24/957/0689)

Citizens have the right to receive a second and subsequent higher education on a contractual basis.

Article 12. Postgraduate education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

Postgraduate education may be received in higher educational and scientific organizations.

Postgraduate education shall provide training of scientific and scientific-pedagogical personnel with a scientific degree on the basis of basic doctoral studies, doctoral studies and independent research, providing for in-depth study of the specialty and conducting scientific research for the preparation and defense of a doctoral dissertation.

Basic doctoral studies is a form of postgraduate education in the specialty of scientific and scientific-pedagogical personnel of higher qualification for applicants for the degree of Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) with a break from production.

Doctoral studies is a form of postgraduate education on the specialty of scientific and scientific-pedagogical staff of higher qualification for applicants for the degree of Doctor of Science (Doctor of Science (DSc) with a break from production.

Independent research is a form of postgraduate education on the specialty of scientific and scientific-pedagogical staff of higher qualification for candidates for the degree of Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) or Doctor of Science (DSc) without taking time off from work.

The order of preparation of scientific and scientific-pedagogical personnel, awarding of scientific degrees and scientific titles, and also features of reception of postgraduate education in military, medical and other educational organizations are defined by the legislation. The duration of postgraduate education is determined by law.

Article 14. Out-of-school education (extracurricular education), Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

In order to meet the needs of children, organize their free time and recreation, State

bodies, non-governmental non-profit organizations and commercial organizations may establish out-of-school educational organizations for cultural, aesthetic, scientific, technical and sports activities.

Out-of-school education as an integral part of the continuing education of children is aimed at developing their talents and abilities and satisfying their spiritual needs.

Out-of-school educational organizations include palaces, houses, clubs and centers for children's and youth creativity, Barkamol Avlod (the perfect generation) children's schools, children's and youth sports schools, children's music and arts schools, studios, information and library and health-improvement establishments.

The procedure for providing out-of-school education shall be determined by the authorized body of state administration in the field of education

Article 15. Forms of receiving education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

Forms of receiving education are:

education on-the-job (full-time);

on-the-job education (correspondence, evening, distance education);

dual education;

education in the family and self-education;

adult learning and education;

inclusive education;

externship education;

training in the field of defense, security and law enforcement.

Article 19. Adult learning and education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997, (as amended on 2020).

Adult learning and education are the central components of lifelong learning, which include all forms of education and learning aimed at ensuring the participation of adults in society and work life, as well as encompassing the totality of formal, non-formal and informal education processes.

Formal education is institutionalized (embodying certain rules and norms), purposeful and planned with the participation of state educational institutions and accredited non-governmental educational organizations.

Non-formal education is institutionalized (embodying certain rules and norms), purposeful and planned by a person or organization providing educational services, is a supplement and (or) alternative to formal education in lifelong learning of an individual.

Informal education is purposeful but not institutionalized (not embodying certain rules and norms), less organized and structured than formal or non-formal education and may include learning activities in the family, workplace, community and everyday life.

Article 20. Inclusive education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

Inclusive education is aimed at ensuring equal access to education in educational organizations for all students, taking into account the diversity of special educational needs and individual capabilities.

Inclusive education shall be organized in educational organizations for children (persons) with physical, mental, sensory (sensory) or mental disorders.

The procedure for organizing inclusive education shall be determined by the Cabinet of Ministers.

Article 38: Admission to study in educational establishments, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997, (as amended on 2020).

Admission to study in educational organizations for all applicants shall be carried out on the basis of the principle of ensuring equal opportunities for education, except for certain categories of persons who, in accordance with the legislation, may be granted privileges.

Educational organizations shall be obliged to acquaint applicants and (or) their parents or other legal representatives with the charter, license or confirmation of receipt of notification (for non-state educational organizations), certificate of state accreditation (except for non-state educational organizations providing extracurricular educational services), curriculum and other documents regulating educational activities, rights and obligations of students.

(Article 38, paragraph two, as amended by Act No. ZRU-721 of October 12, 2021 - National Legislation Database, 12.10.2021, No. 03/21/721/0952)

Children with physical, mental, sensory (perceptual) or psychiatric disabilities are admitted to school with the consent of their parents or other legal representatives and the conclusion of a medical-psychological-pedagogical commission.

Admission to certain educational organizations (higher educational organizations, academic lyceums, Presidential, creative, specialized schools and others) is carried out on a competitive basis

Children with physical, mental, sensory (perceptual) or psychiatric disabilities are admitted to school with the consent of their parents or other legal representatives and the conclusion of a medical-psychological-pedagogical commission.

Admission to certain educational organizations (higher educational organizations, academic lyceums, presidential, creative, specialized schools and others) shall be on a competitive basis. In the course of admission to educational organizations on a competitive basis, participants in the competition shall be provided with information on the procedure for conducting the competition.

(part four of Article 38 in the wording of the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated September 7, 2024, No. ZRU-957 - National Legislation Database, 09.09.2024, No. 03/24/957/0689)

Admission to state higher and professional educational organizations shall be based on a state grant and (or) paid contract.

(part five of Article 38 in the wording of the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan of September 7, 2024, No. ZRU-957 - National Legislation Database, 09.09.2024, No. 03/24/957/0689)

The procedure for admission to state educational institutions and organizations shall be established by the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan.

(part six of Article 38 in the wording of the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated September 7, 2024, No. ZRU-957 - National Legislation Database, 09.09.2024, No. 03/24/957/0689)

The procedure for admission to study in non-governmental educational organizations is established by these educational organizations, taking into account the provisions provided for by the current regulatory legal acts on admission to study in educational organizations.

(part seven of Article 38 as amended by the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated September 7, 2024 No. ZRU-957 — National Database of Legislation, 09.09.2024, No. 03/24/957/0689)

Admission of foreign citizens to state educational institutions of the Republic of Uzbekistan is carried out on the basis of a paid contract (except in cases of allocation of a state grant).

The parameters of admission to higher educational institutions on the basis of a state grant are established by the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan.

(part nine of Article 38 as amended by the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated September 7, 2024 No. ZRU-957 — National Database of Legislation, 09.09.2024, No. 03/24/957/0689)

When applying to study at higher educational institutions, additional admission parameters are set for the privileged contingent.

Chapter 6. Rights and duties of students, their parents and other legal representatives, Article 47: Rights of learners, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

Students have the right to:

receiving general secondary, specialized secondary and initial vocational education on a free basis;

admission to a state general secondary educational institution at the place of residence (microsite);

freedom of choice of forms of education;

receiving quality education that complies with state educational standards, state educational requirements and curricula;

Receipt of the necessary conditions for education that take into account their psychological peculiarities and physiological development, as well as free psychological and medical services;

Participation in the formation of the content of the education they receive, developed in accordance with the requirements of state educational standards for vocational and higher education, in accordance with the procedure established by the state educational institution;

protection of life and health from any physical and psychological violence, personal insults by pedagogical staff and other participants of the educational process;

vacations for recreation and other social needs during the period of education;

receiving academic leaves and scholarships, restoration of education and transfer to other educational organizations, from one form of education, profession, direction of education, specialty to another;

participation in the discussion of issues related to the management of the educational organization;

free use of services of educational, methodical, scientific and production, cultural, sports and living facilities of the educational organization in the process of education;

participation in research, experimental design, scientific and technical, experimental and innovative activities of the educational organization.

Students may have other rights in accordance with the legislation.

It is forbidden in educational organizations to attract students to work not related to education.

Chapter 7. Social protection of participants of the educational process

Article 52. Social protection of students, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

Students in educational organizations in accordance with the legislation shall be provided with benefits, scholarships and places of temporary residence.

Students on a paid-contract basis may be provided with preferential bank loans.

Non-state educational organizations shall provide social protection of students in accordance with the legislation, charter and (or) other constituent document.

The state in order to ensure social protection creates conditions for children from low-income families, children (persons) with physical, mental, sensory (sensory) or mental disorders, as well as for the professional growth of students of this category.

Article 53. Social protection of employees of educational organizations. Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

The state shall guarantee the social protection of workers of educational organizations.

Pedagogical workers of educational organizations shall be granted shorter working hours, annual extended paid leave and other benefits and guarantees.

Pedagogical and other employees of educational organizations are guaranteed health protection through sanitary, hygienic, anti-epidemic and preventive measures.

Educational organizations, within the limits of available funds for remuneration of labor, have the right to independently establish differentiated allowances to wages, official salaries and apply various forms of remuneration and incentives.

Article 54: Education and full provision for orphans and children left without parental care or other legal representatives, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

The education and full support of orphans and children left without parental care or other legal representatives shall be provided at the expense of the State budget of the Republic of Uzbekistan.

Article 55: Education and upbringing of children (persons) with physical, mental, sensory (sensory) or psychiatric disabilities, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

The state shall provide free general secondary, specialized secondary, vocational and out-of-school education of children (persons) with physical, mental, sensory (sensory) or mental disabilities in state specialized educational institutions, general secondary, specialized secondary and vocational educational institutions in inclusive form.

State specialized educational institutions shall be established for the education and upbringing of children with physical, mental, sensory (sensory) or mental disabilities, as well as those in need of long-term treatment. The assignment of students to these educational institutions and their dismissal from them are made on the basis of the conclusion of a medical-psychological-pedagogical commission with the consent of the parents or other legal representatives.

The students of state specialized educational institutions are on state support.

Article 56. Education and upbringing of children (persons) in need of social rehabilitation, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

For children (persons) in need of special conditions of education and upbringing, specialized educational and training institutions are created to ensure their education, vocational training and social rehabilitation.

Conditions are created for children (or persons) held in institutions for the enforcement of sentences of deprivation of liberty.

- ☐ Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education

- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☒ In primary education
- ☒ In secondary education
- ☒ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☒ In higher education
- ☒ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

Today, education in the public education system is conducted in seven languages. The educational process in schools is conducted in Uzbek, as well as in Russian, Karakalpak, Tajik, Kazakh, Kyrgyz and Turkmen languages.

In particular, 5.3 million students are enrolled in 8,883 Uzbek-language schools; 634,000 in 81 Russian-language schools, 126,000 in 241 Karakalpak-language schools, 70,000 in 270 Tajik-language schools, 56,000 in 389 Kazakh-language schools, 8,000 in 52 Kyrgyz-language schools and 9,000 in 43 Turkmen-language schools.

There are 86,000 pre-school education groups in Uzbek, Russian, Karakalpak, Tajik and Kazakh, attended by 1,959,021 children. The Ministry of Preschool Education, with the support of the National Television and Radio Company of Uzbekistan (in Uzbek and Russian), has organized morning exercises based on the “First Step” project, “Ancient Cities of Uzbekistan” (in Uzbek), “English” (in English), “Basics of mental counting and mathematical calculations” and classes with a speech therapist. The “First Step” television programs also include cooking master classes, “Creativity” - drawing and appliqué lessons, and dance master classes. TV programs on mental arithmetic, elementary mathematics and speech therapy are organized as additional educational content for children aged 6-7.

☐ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum:

- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☒ In primary education
- ☒ In secondary education
- ☒ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☒ In higher education
- ☒ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

Educational institutions at all levels provide education in 7 languages (Kazakh, Turkmen, Tajik, Kyrgyz, Karakalpak, Russian and Uzbek). As of 2020/2021 in the Republic of Karakalpakstan, there are currently 371 schools in Karakalpak language with 125,767 students enrolled

All general education schools in the Republic of Karakalpakstan teach “History of Karakalpakstan” in addition to the subject “History of Uzbekistan”, and the regional departments of ecology and environmental protection organize classes in general education

schools on the development of the Karakalpak ethnos and the environmental situation in the region and seminars on environmental education for teachers at local secondary schools.

For the 2024-2025 school year, there are 9445 Uzbek-teaching schools with 5600619 pupils, 380 Karakalpak-teaching schools with 124726 pupils, 946 Russian-teaching schools with 685334 pupils, 237 Tajik-teaching schools with 64832 pupils, 46 Kyrgyz-teaching schools with 7345 pupils, 354 Kazakh-teaching schools with 48666 pupils, 43 Turkmen-teaching schools with 10971 pupils.

The total number of pupils is 6542493, of which 3,215,066 are girls.

☐ Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

Special sections have been created on the social networks of the Ministry of Preschool and School Education, its regional departments, and district (city) departments aimed at raising awareness about the elimination of all forms of discrimination.

Information events with the participation of psychologists are constantly regularly organized in secondary schools:

1. Conducting legal literacy classes in general education schools using interactive methods in order to form a legal culture from childhood.
2. Instilling a legal culture among young people, including concepts of equality between women and men, creating animated short films and social videos aimed at creating a sense of intolerance to violence.
3. Holding meetings on the topic “Do you know your rights and obligations?” among young people in the framework of the “Crime Prevention Day” held every Thursday.
4. Holding a human rights week to raise awareness and awareness of human rights. The week provides information on various topics such as children's rights, gender equality, religious freedom, freedom of speech and others.

1.2 Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education

- Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked):

General measures:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for inclusive education for all | ☒ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ¹⁷ are provided for |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all | ☒ Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design ¹⁸ |
| ☒ Teachers are trained on inclusive education ¹⁶ and to value diversity | ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education is supported |
| ☒ Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

The Law “On Preschool Education and Up bringing” of December 16, 2019 defined the main directions of the state policy in the field of preschool education and upbringing of the child, including children with special educational needs.

In the 2021-2022 school year, 21,685 children with special educational needs received education in specialized schools and boarding schools, including 6,474 in sanatorium-type boarding schools for children with tuberculosis and bone diseases and 14,059 individually at home. On 7 June 2021, the Act on the ratification of the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities was signed, and in order to ensure the right of every child to inclusive education, inclusive classes were organized in general education schools in the 2021-2022 school year.

As of December 2022, 204 inclusive classes were organized in 195 schools in the country. These schools have all the conditions for the education of children with special educational needs, in particular ramps, special furniture, sanitary and hygienic facilities, as well as teaching materials and teaching staff.

According to the Presidential Decree of 20.08.2020, the Concept of development of inclusive education in the school and preschool system for the period from 2020 to 2025 was approved. Within the framework of this concept, starting from the academic year 2021-2022, inclusive classes have been organized in 35 general education schools in Tashkent on a pilot basis. During the school year 2021-2022, 122 children with special educational needs studied in these classes. By the 2022-2023 school year, the number of inclusive schools increased to 195,

¹⁶ Teachers are prepared to teach all student (beyond just students with disabilities), equipping them with knowledge, values and attitudes that permit every student to succeed. See: [UNESCO policy paper](#): Inclusive teaching: preparing all teachers to teach all students, 2020, p.14.

¹⁷ Multiple and flexible learning pathways are ‘entry points and re-entry points at all ages and all educational levels, strengthened links between formal and non-formal structures, and recognition, validation and accreditation of the knowledge, skills and competencies acquired through nonformal and informal education’ ([Education 2030 Framework for Action](#), para. 33). This may include student transfers between courses and institutions and diverse learning modalities (online, in-person, full-time, part-time, etc.) to respond to individual needs and interests.

¹⁸ In designing the curricula and teaching methods, care is given to ensure that all students are provided with an inclusive and supportive learning experience that offers them the opportunity to succeed whatever their background.

and the number of children with special educational needs in them reached 504.

Since the 2021/22 academic year, an inclusive education system has been introduced, initial basic remedial classes for children with special needs have been opened in the regions, and an “Inclusive Education Laboratory” has been set up at the National Center for Professional Guidance and Psychological and Pedagogical Diagnosis of Students. Further measures are being taken to introduce a system of inclusive education for persons with disabilities, including the training and retraining of teaching staff.

According to target 4.5 of the Sustainable Development Goals, by 2025 the share of educational institutions with the introduction of inclusive education in Uzbekistan will be increased by 51%, and the share of children with special educational needs studying in inclusive education will be increased by 40%.

Home education has been established for children who do not have access to education in State schools and specialized boarding schools, with 14,059 children enrolled. Each year, a set of 12 educational supplies is delivered free of charge to these students.

Besides this, 96% of children continued their education during the period of self-isolation and school closure, and distance learning methods as well as hybrid learning methodologies were used to support the learning process.

In the 2021-2022 school year, 21,685 children with special educational needs received education in specialized schools and boarding schools, including 6,474 in sanatorium-type boarding schools for children with tuberculosis and bone diseases and 14,059 individually at home. On 7 June 2021, the Act on the ratification of the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities was signed, and in order to ensure the right of every child to inclusive education, inclusive classes were organized in general education schools in the 2021-2022 school year.

As of December 2022, 204 inclusive classes were organized in 195 schools in the country. These schools have all conditions for the education of children with special educational needs, such as ramps, special furniture, sanitary and hygienic premises, as well as teaching materials and teaching staff. In order to develop an inclusive education system oriented towards women, an additional 4% state grant for girls entering higher education was introduced from the 2020/2021 academic year. As a result, women accounted for 45.6% of the students enrolled in higher education. Since 2022, the state has financed interest-free educational loans for 7 years to pay for the educational contracts of women studying in higher education institutions, technical schools and colleges. As a result, the number of women in higher education institutions has increased significantly

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

There is still a room for improvement to create equal opportunities to the education processes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☒ Legislation provides for gender equality in education | ☒ All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality | ☒ Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for |
| ☒ Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken | ☒ Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities ²⁰ |
| ☒ Providing positive or affirmative action measures | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²¹ and bias |
| ☒ Providing financial incentives and fellowships | ☒ Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) |
| ☒ Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality | ☒ Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET) |
| ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ¹⁹ | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

The Presidential Decree of March 7, 2022 approved the National Program for Increasing the Activity of Women in All Spheres of Economic, Political and Social Life of the Country for 2022–2026. According to the Decree, conditions have been created to ensure girls' access to education, in particular:

- Interest-free loans for a period of 7 years are issued to pay for educational contracts(bachelor's degree), technical schools and colleges. 84,640 students studying in higher education institutions have been granted interest-free educational loans worth 872.2 billion soums for a period of 7 years.

- 150 female students from socially needy families, orphans or those left without parental care from each oblast (a total of 2,100) are paid for educational contracts on a non-refundable basis annually from additional sources of local budgets. In 2022, in order to support low-income women in accessing education, 35,689 out of 84,104 women in need were awarded letters of recommendation for admission to higher education through the xotin-qizlar.uz platform. Based on the results of the tests, 1,982 female students with the highest scores were admitted to higher education institutions on the basis of a State grant;

- In addition, 500 women who have at least 5 years of work experience in their

¹⁹ ' Stigmatisation is the act of treating someone or something unfairly by publicly disapproving of them' (Cambridge Dictionary).

²⁰ ' Gender-sensitive sanitation includes clean, safe and separate toilets, with access to water and garbage disposal' ([UNGEI blog post](#), Gender-sensitive sanitation, 2018)

²¹ Stereotype is a set idea that people have about what someone or something is like, especially an idea that is wrong' (Cambridge Dictionary).

specialty but no higher education will be able to enroll in bachelor's programs in accordance with the results of the tests on a paid-contract basis. To date, 28,664 women have been recommended for admission to State higher education institutions on a preferential basis;

- The El-Yurt Umidi Foundation annually allocates grants for women to study in foreign universities: 50 for bachelor's degree programs and 10 for master's degree programs. Every year it is planned to allocate at least 300 target quotas for women in doctoral studies at scientific organizations or higher education institutions.

- Funded on a non-refundable basis the contractual payments of all women enrolled in master's programs. The Government will allocate at least 200 billion soums for this purpose;

- Women's scientific activity will be encouraged through the allocation of an additional 300 doctoral places specifically for women who plan to pursue science.

- Due to the measures taken, the number of girls graduating from tertiary education in the 2022/2023 academic year is 48133, compared to 26858 in the 2018/2019 academic year.

In addition, sufficient conditions are created in schools for girls with early pregnancy to study subjects without interruption, receive special education, take examinations in an appropriate manner and obtain a certificate. In particular, every year, at the end of the school year, a final State external examination is organized for citizens who, for various reasons, were unable to complete general secondary education. In accordance with the Cabinet of Ministers Decision of June 1, 2022, applications for externship examinations are accepted through the unified portal of State services (my.gov.uz) by submitting an application between March 1 and May 1. In 2023, 12919 applications were received to take state externship examinations in order to obtain a certificate. 41,420 colleges were approved (including 10,989 grants, 26.5%) and 23,486 applicants were admitted.

Educational reforms have been implemented to ensure access to higher education for women and girls, which have resulted in an increase in enrolment of young people in higher education from 9 per cent to 42 per cent in recent years and a 3.5-fold increase in the number of higher education institutions.

- What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Persistent gender stereotypes and traditional views on the role of women in the family and society remain one of the obstacles to full gender equality.

- Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) ²²:

Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are

more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

- The Constitution establishes constitutional guarantees of free and equal consent to marriage (article 76 of the Constitution); as well as the principle of the voluntary nature of the marriage union of a man and a woman (article 2 of the Family Code) and the inadmissibility of coercion to enter into marriage (article 14 of the Family Code), the age of marriage for men and women is set at eighteen years (Article 15 of the Family Code);

- In 2019 Equal Rights and Opportunities for Women and Men (Safeguards for Equal Rights and Opportunities for Women and Men) Act was adopted, which establishes guarantees of equal rights and opportunities for women and men in the area of family relations, based on the principles of the voluntariness of marriage between women and men and the prohibition of forced and early marriages, among others.

- Administrative and criminal liability has been established for violation of the legislation on the age of marriage and the procedure for marriage (for entering into actual marital relations with a person under the age of marriage; for giving in marriage or marrying a person under the age of marriage by parents or persons in loco parentis; for performing a religious rite for the conclusion of a marriage between persons whose marriage is not registered in accordance with the procedure established by law, including with a person under the age of marriage; for forcing a woman to marry a person under the age of marriage; for forcing a person under the age of marriage to marry a person under the age of marriage; for forcing a woman to marry a person under the age of marriage; for forcing a person under the age of marriage to marry a person under the age of marriage

National minorities: -

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities.

☒ Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities

☒ Teachers are trained on intercultural education

☒ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities

☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation²⁴

☒ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities

☒ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported

☒ The right to carry out their own educational

☒ Native language instruction is ensured

activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities

- ☒ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities
- ☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities
- ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities
- ☐ Other²³:

for national minorities

☒ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities

☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes²⁵ and bias

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

The State Inspectorate for Quality Control in Education under the Cabinet of Ministers monitored the Law on Education and more than 200 regulatory legal acts. In order to regulate interethnic relations in the country, more than 40 laws and other normative legal acts have been adopted, directly aimed at preventing discrimination against citizens and other persons living in the country on the basis of national or ethnic affiliation, language or religion, ensuring interethnic harmony and tolerance, creating equal conditions and opportunities for the realization of their rights, freedoms and legitimate interests.

Article 6 of the Labor Code of 01.04.1996, which is called "Prohibition of discrimination in labor relations" notes that "all citizens have equal opportunities to possess and use labor rights. The establishment of any restrictions or the provision of advantages in the field of labor relations depending on gender, age, race, nationality, language, social origin, property and official status, attitude to religion, beliefs, membership in public associations, as well as other circumstances not related to the business qualities of employees and the results of their work, is unacceptable and constitutes discrimination.

Consistent measures have been taken to identify problems of the Lyuli/Roma ethnic group, including Lyuli/Roma women, in obtaining identity documents, birth certificates for children, in realizing the right to education, health services, employment, social security, housing and other socio-economic rights.

According to the Ministry of Internal Affairs, as of May 2021, there were 86,563 Lyuli/Roma in the country, of whom 45,092 were women and 41,471 men, 46,422 were minors who had reached the age of 16; 38,733 had a passport, 25,925 were under 16, of whom 16,719 had a birth certificate. A total of 53,666 persons were interviewed at their place of residence; 22 had certificates of residence for stateless persons and 3 had residence permits for foreign nationals in Uzbekistan. Measures were taken to document 112 persons; identity documents were provided to: 256

²³ Please see: [UNESCO report](#) 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023.

²⁵ Supra note 16.

persons without birth certificates, identity cards and birth certificates

Sociological and monitoring studies have shown that the Lyuli/Roma living in Uzbekistan represent a separate ethnographic group, whose representatives are descendants of Lyuli/Roma of Indian origin who settled in Uzbekistan and Tajikistan.

Among educated respondents there are more men than women (47.8% and 36.4% respectively), women do not complete compulsory general education (41.7%), and only men have secondary specialized education (36.4%). The majority (85.7%) confirmed that the state does not restrict their children's rights to primary, secondary and general secondary education.

According to the Ministry of School and Preschool Education, 10,856 children are at home, 14,471 are in school, 444 are in Preschool education establishments, 157 are in colleges, and 441 are in school institutions. According to the data of the Ministry of Education, 53 lyuli/roma students are studying in 2 higher and 7 specialized secondary vocational educational institutions. An action plan is being implemented to cover their education.

In order to create all conditions for the development of the language and culture of all nationalities and ethnic groups living in the Republic of Uzbekistan, expanding coverage and providing information in foreign languages (languages of different nationalities), the Television and Radio Broadcasting Company has created an editorial board of information and educational programs, which currently broadcasts a total of 12 television programs twice a month: in Tajik - "Ranginkamon"; Kazakh - "Didar"; in Korean - "Chinsen"; in Karakalpak - "Naopir". The program "Uzbekistan - Our Common Home" - about the way of life and traditions of different nationalities and ethnic groups living in the country, which is broadcast twice a month.

There are 86,000 pre-school education groups in Uzbek, Russian, Karakalpak, Tajik and Kazakh, attended by 1,959,021 children. The Ministry of Preschool Education, with the support of the National Television and Radio Company of Uzbekistan (in Uzbek and Russian), has organized morning exercises based on the "First Step" project, "Ancient Cities of Uzbekistan" (in Uzbek), "English" (in English), "Basics of mental counting and mathematical calculations" and classes with a speech therapist. The "First Step" project's television programs also include cooking master classes, "Creativity" - drawing and applique lessons, and dance master classes. TV programs on mental arithmetic, elementary mathematics and speech therapy are organized as additional educational content for children aged 6-7.

According to Article 6 of the Law on Preschool Education and Upbringing, every child has the right to preschool education and upbringing. The State guarantees the right of every child to undergo one year of compulsory preparation for general secondary education in public pre-school institutions one year before entering general education.

Today, education in the public education system is conducted in seven languages. The educational process in schools is conducted in Uzbek, as well as in Russian, Karakalpak, Tajik, Kazakh, Kyrgyz and Turkmen languages. In particular, 5.3 million students are enrolled in 8,883 Uzbek-language schools, 634,000 in 81 Russian-language schools, 126,000 in 241 Karakalpak-language schools, 70,000 in

270 Tajik-language schools, 56,000 in 389 Kazakh-language schools, 8,000 in 52 Kyrgyz-language schools, and 9,000 in 43 Turkmen-language schools.

The Tashkent State Law University is attended by representatives of 16 peoples living in Uzbekistan (Russians, Koreans, Turks, Turkmens, Tatars, Tajiks, Azerbaijanis and others). The Department of International Law and Human Rights of the TSJU has developed a module on human rights for second-year students of the International Law and Comparative Law Faculty of the University, which includes a separate study of the human rights of ethnic groups, including migrants, refugees, foreign nationals and stateless persons, as well as issues related to combating torture and discrimination, the provisions of the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination and the Durban Declaration and Programme of Action.

The editorial office of the Dustlik information and educational programmes on the Uzbekiston television channel works to promote the language, customs and traditions of the nations and nationalities of Uzbekistan and to provide information about them in foreign languages, including the languages of the various nationalities living in the country: “Tarim” (in Uighur), ‘Chansen’ (in Korean), ‘Ўzbekiston - umumiy uyimiz’ (in Uzbek), ‘Diydar’ (in Kazakh), ‘Ranginkamon’ (in Tajik) and ‘Shanarak’ (in Karakalpak).

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

More focus should be dedicated to high education of minority groups

Indigenous people:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people | ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people | ☒ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ☒ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁶ |
| ☒ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people | ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| ☒ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people | ☒ Native language instruction is ensured |
| ☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people | ☒ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people |
| | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²⁷ and bias |

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Much attention is paid to creating opportunities for the preservation and further development of national customs, traditions and the native language of ethnic groups living in Karakalpakstan. The President and the Government have adopted and are implementing a number of important documents aimed at the socio-economic development of the Republic of Karakalpakstan and the development of the national culture and art of the Karakalpak people. At present, 5 projects have been financed at the expense of the Trust Fund to the amount of 9.1 million US dollars, which have led to the following results: drinking water has been provided to 3.5 thousand people in 5 communities of Takhtakupir district, assistance has been provided to 6 economic entities in the development of production, the material and technical base of farms under the State Forestry Committee has been provided with 17 types of modern special equipment. Infrastructure and material and technical base of perinatal centers of Nukus, Beruni and Kungrad districts were modernized with 42 types of modern equipment, 5 additional perinatal services were provided, their number increased from 8,500 to 20,000 per year.

The “Karakalpakstan” TV and radio company regularly broadcasts a series of programs such as “Tilge Itibar”, “Ana tilinde soyylemiz”, “Sheshenlik sheberligi”, “Til - millet aynasy”. It is planned to publish a multi-volume “Explanatory Dictionary of the Karakalpak language”, filled with new words, to implement grant projects on the prospects of the Karakalpak and Uzbek languages in the Republic of Karakalpakstan. Karakalpak Language Day is held annually on December 1. There are 3 State theaters, 2 State museums and their 2 branches, 2 specialized schools of culture and art, 22 children's music and art schools, the Karakalpak State national folklore ensemble “Aykulash”, the ensemble “Makom”, the Karakalpak branch of “Uzbekkontsert”, the Republican Library for the Blind and its 9 branches, 16 city and district departments of culture, 58 houses of culture.

Karakalpakstan has 3 higher educational institutions, 6 branches of higher educational institutions, 54 specialized secondary educational institutions, 727 general education schools in which Karakalpak language is taught as a state language.

Adoption of the Presidential Decree of 11.11.2020 “On measures for comprehensive socio-economic development of the Republic of Karakalpakstan for 2020-2023” promoted the development of its social infrastructure. “On measures for the comprehensive socio-economic development of the Republic of Karakalpakstan for 2020-2023” promoted the development of its social infrastructure, carried out: construction of 38 state pre-school educational organizations, 400 family pre-school educational organizations, reconstruction of 35 pre-school educational organizations. The construction of 7 general education schools and the renovation of 101 schools made it possible to ensure that the enrollment rate in general education secondary schools did not exceed 1.1%. The creation of 32 medical institutions and private medical organizations increased the capacity of medical institutions to 20,400 and the number of beds to 7,100. The reconstruction of 21 cultural facilities improved the quality of cultural services, met the population's cultural needs and provided meaningful leisure time; the inclusion of 181 schools in the “One Million Programmers”

project and the training of more than 3,000 young people in the basics of computer programming contributed to the training of advanced specialists in the field of digital technologies and ensured the development of new technologies.

Today, education in the public education system is conducted in seven languages. The educational process in schools is conducted in Uzbek, as well as in Russian, Karakalpak, Tajik, Kazakh, Kyrgyz and Turkmen languages. In particular, 5.3 million students are enrolled in 8,883 Uzbek-language schools, 634,000 in 81 Russian-language schools, 126,000 in 241 Karakalpak-language schools, 70,000 in 270 Tajik-language schools, 56,000 in 389 Kazakh-language schools, 8,000 in 52 Kyrgyz-language schools, and 9,000 in 43 Turkmen-language schools.

Based on the implementation of 107 regulatory and legal acts defining the long-term and short-term prospects of the preschool education system, the coverage of children aged 3-7 with preschool education increased from 27% to 70% (from 708,000 to 1,959,000 children). Through the development of preschool education, the number of preschool education organizations increased from 5,211 to 28,842. Alternative types of preschool education are being developed: mobile and playgroups are being widely introduced. In order to ensure healthy and safe nutrition for preschool-age children, a mechanism for healthy nutrition through outsourcing has been established in 1,176 preschool educational institutions and 83 enterprises for 237,922 students. All facilities have been created for children with disabilities. For example, in the Republic of Karakalpakstan and the Tashkent and Kashkadarya provinces, multidisciplinary specialized preschool organizations have been set up with an “Imkon” (Opportunity) rehabilitation center, where all facilities are available for children with disabilities.

There are 86,000 pre-school education groups in Uzbek, Russian, Karakalpak, Tajik and Kazakh, attended by 1,959,021 children. The Ministry of Preschool Education, with the support of the National Television and Radio Company of Uzbekistan (in Uzbek and Russian), has organized morning exercises based on the “First Step” project, “Ancient Cities of Uzbekistan” (in Uzbek), “English” (in English), “Basics of mental counting and mathematical calculations” and classes with a speech therapist. The “First Step” project's television programs also include cooking master classes, “Creativity” - drawing and applique lessons, and dance master classes. TV programs on mental arithmetic, elementary mathematics and speech therapy are organized as additional educational content for children aged 6-7.

In the Republic of Karakalpakstan, in order to increase the level of enrolment in higher education, the Councils of Ministers and provincial administrations, together with the Ministry of Higher Education, have established in each province, by 1 September 2021, public organizations and systems of education and upbringing in the mother tongue of ethnic groups. In accordance with article 33 of the Education Act and article 6 of the State Language Act, the right of persons living in the Republic of Karakalpakstan to free choice of language of instruction is being realized. Educational institutions at all levels provide instruction in seven languages (Kazakh, Turkmen, Tajik, Kyrgyz, Karakalpak, Russian and Uzbek). As of 2020/2021 in the Republic of Karakalpakstan, there are currently 371 schools in the Karakalpak language with 125,767 students.

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ethnic groups. In accordance with article 33 of the Education Act and article 6 of the State Language Act, the right of persons living in the Republic of Karakalpakstan to free choice of language of instruction is being realized. Educational institutions at all levels provide instruction in seven languages (Kazakh, Turkmen, Tajik, Kyrgyz, Karakalpak, Russian and Uzbek). As of 2020/2021 in the Republic of Karakalpakstan, there are currently 371 schools in the Karakalpak language with 125,767 students.

All general education schools in the Republic of Karakalpakstan teach “History of Karakalpakstan” in addition to the subject “History of Uzbekistan”, and the regional departments of ecology and environmental protection organize classes in general education schools on the development of the Karakalpak ethnos and the environmental situation in the region and seminars on environmental education for teachers at local secondary schools.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

More focus should be dedicated to higher education of indigenous people

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations²⁸:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☒ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☒ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☒ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ³¹ are provided |
| ☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³² and bias |
| ☒ All administrative barriers to access education are removed | ☒ Accelerated learning programmes are provided |
| ☒ Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers ²⁹ are provided for | ☒ Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided |
| ☒ Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion | ☒ Language classes to newcomers are provided for |
| | ☒ Multilingualism and intercultural education |

²⁸ ‘Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards’ ([UNESCO report](#): The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2).

²⁹ While lack of documentation (such as identity papers, birth certificates, residency permits, etc.) should not be an obstacle to access education, these can constitute a barrier to education See: [UNESCO publication](#): Handbook on the right to education, 2018, p. 96.

☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation³⁰ are encouraged

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Decision of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. 169 on improving the procedure for admission and education of foreign nationals in educational institutions of the Republic of Uzbekistan.

In 2021, the following acts were adopted: the Legal Status of Foreign Nationals and Stateless Persons Act; the Ratification of the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act; and the Amendments and Additions to the Citizenship Act;

According to the law “On the legal status of foreign citizens and stateless persons in the Republic of Uzbekistan” of 4.06.2021 “foreign citizens and stateless persons in the territory of the Republic of Uzbekistan are equal before the law without distinction as to sex, race, nationality, language, religion, social origin, beliefs, personal and social status”

- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please elaborate:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

People with disabilities:

☒ Legislation provides for their right to education

☒ Policy measures aim to enhance their

☐ Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities

☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation³³

³¹ Supra note 13

³² Supra note 16.

³⁰ Supra note 15.

- right to education
- ☐ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured
- ☒ Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools
- ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided
- ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Auxiliary assistance is provided
- ☐ Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted
- ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes³⁴ and bias
- ☐ Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Article 3 of the Law “On the Rights of Persons with Disabilities” dated October 15, 2020 defines the concept of “discrimination on the basis of disability”, meaning that any separation, exclusion, exclusion, restriction due to disability, the purpose or result of which is the denial of recognition or implementation on an equal basis with others of the rights and freedoms of persons with disabilities in the political, economic, social, cultural, civil or other field.

The law prohibits discrimination on the basis of disability: “any singling out, exclusion, exclusion, restriction or preference for persons with disabilities, as well as refusal to create conditions for access of persons with disabilities to facilities and services, is prohibited. Special measures aimed at ensuring equality of opportunity for persons with disabilities and their inclusion in the life of society and the state are not considered discriminatory in relation to other citizens”

In 2020, the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act came into force, through which rights and guarantees are provided to people with disabilities for housing, including concessionary housing, education and employment.

Article 18 (2) of the Law on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities stipulates that in order to ensure equal opportunities and prevent discrimination on the basis of disability, State bodies shall take measures to ensure equal access of persons with disabilities to facilities and services, social, economic and cultural spheres, health care, education, employment, as well as information and means of communication.

Children with disabilities shall enjoy full enjoyment of all human rights and freedoms on an equal basis with other children. In all actions taken with regard to children with disabilities, the supremacy of their interests shall be a priority, with a view to the full and harmonious development of children with disabilities, the promotion of their social activity, their interest in work, and their involvement in education, science, technology, art and sport (article 8 of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act).

- Improvement of the system of inclusive education and employment of persons with disabilities, ensuring their inclusion and active participation in the social and economic

³³ Supra note 15.

³⁴ Supra note 16.

life of society; simplification of procedures for establishing disability and providing medical and social assistance; modernization, technical and technological upgrading of enterprises for the production of prosthetic and orthopedic devices and technical rehabilitation equipment; organization of educational work in society on respect for the rights and dignity of persons with disabilities.

The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act enshrines the rights of persons with disabilities to education and to work (arts. 32-43).

The State creates conditions for full access for persons with disabilities to the facilities and services of the social, economic and cultural spheres, facilitates their employment and education, and ensures that they can obtain the information they need without hindrance (Constitution, art. 57, para. 3).

The state guarantees the development of inclusive education, creation of necessary conditions for access of persons with disabilities to education and vocational training, retraining and advanced training.

Persons with disabilities are exempted from payment or on preferential terms special teaching aids and literature, as well as the possibility of using sign language interpreters. In 2018-2020, children with bn disability graduated from vocational colleges (in 2018 — 803); (in 2019 — 788); (in 2020 — 59), in higher education institutions studied in 2018 — 76 (women — 30; men — 46); in 2019 — 59 (women — 24; men — 35); in 2020 — 59 (women — 13; men — 46).

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Students from poor households:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided | ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³⁵ |
| ☒ meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³⁶ and bias |
| ☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided | |
| ☐ Other: | |

A number of benefits for self-employment have been introduced since 2021, including the introduction of a mechanism to provide subsidies for unemployed people and women in

³⁵ Supra note 15.

³⁶ Supra note 16.

difficult social situations who are included in the Iron Notebook, Women's Notebook and Youth Notebook to start their activities. Also, 8 thousand women and girls included in the “**Youth Notebook**” are allocated subsidies to start their own business and purchase inventory, 10 thousand - soft loans. A “Business Marathon” project will be launched for 50 thousand young women with the participation of qualified specialists. The project will provide hundreds of talented girls with practical assistance in setting up a business.

In the current academic year, 1,914 girls from needy families have been admitted to higher education institutions under additional State grants. More than 181,500 girls received preferential educational loans. Local budgets covered the contract amount of more than 2,000 students from families in need of social protection, orphaned students or students deprived of parental care for 14 billion 500 million soums. In recent years, the contracts of girls studying in the master's program of state higher education institutions have been covered from the budget.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

The Presidential Decree of July 25, 2022 approved the Social Protection Strategy, which provides for the creation of a system of guarantees of a minimum level of social protection for all citizens in accordance with ILO Recommendation No. 202 “On Social Protection Floors”. The Social Protection Strategy covers four areas such as social assistance, social services, social insurance (retirement pensions, payments in case of temporary disability, unemployment, etc.) and access to active labor market programs/policies for the most vulnerable. Also, a chapter on institutional reforms in the social protection system has been added as a fifth strand.

The Presidential Decree “On the New Uzbekistan Development Strategy for 2022-2026” provides for:

- Creation of a separate database on women, young people and persons with disabilities in the information system “Unified Register of Social Protection”;
- The inclusion in the employment record of the time spent caring for children with disabilities from childhood up to the age of 18 when granting pensions;

In order to support low-income families, “iron books” have been introduced, on the basis of which some 600,000 needy families have been provided with material assistance by decisions of local representative bodies. Financial assistance was provided to 479,400 families at the expense of the Sakhovat and Kumak Fund.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

--

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education . This question refers to the Ministry of Preschool and school education

2.1 Early childhood care and education

For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation³⁷ and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education³⁸. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked):

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free | ☒ ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play. |
| ☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable | |
| ☒ ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis | |

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

Current demographic statistics in the country:

The population of Uzbekistan is 37.0 million people (according to comp. as of April 2024), of which 3.0 million. these are preschool children from 3 to 7 years old. The annual population growth is almost 1 million children per year. And by 2030, it is expected that the population of Uzbekistan will amount to more than 40 million people.

In Uzbekistan, public preschool educational organizations of a general type are designed for children aged 3 to 7 years, while educational organizations for children with disabilities (special needs), as well as private kindergartens can accept children from the age of two. In addition, the pre-school education system has introduced one-year pre-school training for 6-year-olds on a free basis since 2019.

Public and private sector:

Since the establishment of the Ministry of Preschool Education, the department has pursued an active policy of attracting the private sector to the field of preschool education. This has led to the fact that the share of coverage of children by the non-governmental sector currently stands at 62%.

“In comparison, in 2017 there were only 250 non-governmental kindergartens, when by 2024 the figure was more than 27,162 thousand.. Of these, 91% are family-owned pre-school, 6% are based on PPP, 3% are Private.”

By 2030, in order to ensure equal inclusive access to pre-school education in the country, it is planned to reach the number of 46,770.

³⁷ Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”.
³⁸ Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE”

Inclusion in preschool education.

There are 74 specialized preschool educational organizations in the republic, including 69 state multidisciplinary specialized preschool educational organizations, 4 state multidisciplinary specialized preschool educational organizations with the rehabilitation center “Imkon” (Nukus, Karshi, Kibrai district) and “Umid” (Zarafshan) and 1 state preschool educational organization of the combined type (Tashkent).

The capacity of these preschool educational organizations is designed for 650 groups for children with disabilities in physical or mental development, currently there are 576 groups in which 6,007 pupils aged 2 to 7 years receive education and upbringing, of which:

43 groups for children with severe hearing impairment (452 pupils);

44 groups for children with severe visual impairment (470 pupils);

169 groups for children with mental retardation (1828 pupils);

120 groups for children with mental retardation (1,107 pupils);

122 groups for children with musculoskeletal disorders (1,362 pupils);

78 groups for children with severe speech disorders (858 pupils)

Out of 6,007 pupils, 3,153 children (52%) are children with disabilities. Of these, 5,525 pupils (91%) are not charged parental fees.

- Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available?

☐ Pre-primary education is compulsory. **Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:**

☒ Pre-primary education is **not** compulsory.

☐ Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. **Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:**

☒ Pre-primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Preschool education and care,
of December 16, 2019 No. ZRU-595, (as amended on 07-09-2024)

Accepted by Legislative house on October 22, 2019.

Article 6. State guarantees for receipt of preschool education and education

Each child has the right to preschool education and education.

The state guarantees the right of each child to obtaining in the state preschool educational

organizations of obligatory year preparation for general secondary education one year prior to its receipt in the organization of general secondary education.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Limited access | ☐ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Low number of professionally trained educators |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | ☐ Lack of support to families |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Pre-school education coverage from 2017 to 2023 Thanks to the effective and creative policy in Uzbekistan as well as the coordinated work of the Ministry of Pre-School and School Education of Uzbekistan, in 6 years we have managed to almost triple (from 27% to 74.0%) the indicators for the coverage of children, as well as ensuring access to preschool education. Today, 74.0% of the total number of children aged 3-6 years have the opportunity to attend preschool and receive an education appropriate for their age. Taking into account all the changes and trends, the country's leadership has set a course to achieve 100% of the target by 2030.

2.2 Primary and secondary education . This question refers to the Ministry of Preschool and school education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide “12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory.”

Primary education

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education:

- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge?

- ☒ Primary education is compulsory
- ☐ Primary education is **not** compulsory.

☒ Primary education is free of charge.

☐ Primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Constitution of the Republic of Uzbekistan (adopted on May 1, 2023);
Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On Education” (adopted on September 23, 2020 No. ZRU-637);
Law “On Preschool Education and Upbringing”, 2019.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education?

☐ Limited access

☐ Issues of equity and inclusion

☐ High dropout rates

☐ Poor quality programmes

☐ Other:

☐ Poor learning outcomes in:

Foundation literacy

Numeracy

Social and emotional learning

Others

☐ Disparity in learning outcomes

☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Secondary education .

In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:

Article 9. General secondary and secondary special education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997 , (as amended on 2020).

General secondary and secondary special education is aimed at acquiring general educational programs, necessary knowledge, skills and abilities.

The stages of general secondary education (grades I - XI) are as follows: primary education (grades I - IV); basic secondary education (grades V - IX); secondary education (X - XI)

grades).

Children are admitted to the first grade of general secondary education in the year they turn seven. Primary education aims to form the foundations of literacy, knowledge, skills, and competencies necessary for students to continue general secondary education. The basic secondary education curriculum provides students with the required amount of knowledge, skills, and abilities, and helps develop their ability to think independently and analyze information.

In the framework of basic secondary education (after the 7th grade), measures are taken for professional diagnosis and vocational guidance to help students form basic knowledge and skills related to various professions. The acquisition of necessary knowledge, skills, and competencies by students according to the secondary education curriculum ensures their choice of further education and enables them to pursue professions that do not require high qualifications.

The procedure for professional diagnosis and career orientation, as well as preparing students for professions that do not require high qualifications, is established by legislation. General secondary education is carried out continuously in general secondary education institutions for eleven compulsory years. Secondary special education is implemented in academic lyceums for two years based on a foundation of nine years of basic secondary education, ensuring the rapid development of intellectual abilities and providing a deep, differentiated, career-oriented, and individualized education for learners.

Private general secondary education institutions operate based on a license and in accordance with the state educational standards. In non-state educational organizations, general secondary and secondary special education may be provided on a fee-contract basis. To nurture the abilities of gifted and talented children, the President may establish specialized schools, including creative and other specialized schools, as well as boarding schools. Children with physical, mental, sensory (perceptual), or psychological disabilities, as well as children needing long-term treatment, receive education in state specialized educational institutions, general secondary and secondary special education institutions in an inclusive format or individually at home. The number of students in classes (or groups) in general secondary education institutions should not exceed thirty-five.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:

--

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge?

☒ Lower secondary education is compulsory.

☐ Lower secondary education is **not** compulsory.

☒ Lower secondary education is free of charge.

☐ Lower secondary education is **not** free of charge.

☐ Upper secondary education is compulsory.

☒ Upper secondary education is **not** compulsory.

☐ Upper secondary education is free of charge

☐ Upper secondary education is **not** free of charge.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Constitution of the Republic of Uzbekistan (adopted on May 1, 2023);
Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On Education” (adopted on September 23, 2020 No. ZRU-637);
Article 10. Professional education, Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997, (as amended on 2020).

Professional education includes the following degrees in the profession and specialty:

primary professional education; secondary professional education;

secondary special professional education.

Primary professional education is provided in vocational schools for graduates of the 9th grade on a free basis, through two-year integrated programs that combine general education subjects and specialized subjects, offered in a full-time format.

Secondary professional education is carried out in colleges based on a state order or payment contract, depending on the complexity of professions and specialties. It is provided on the basis of general secondary, secondary special, and primary professional education in full-time, evening, and part-time formats, with a duration of up to two years. Secondary specialized professional education is provided in technical schools based on general secondary, secondary special, primary professional, and secondary professional education. This education is delivered based on a state order or payment contract, depending on the complexity of professions and specialties, in full-time, evening, and part-time formats, with a duration of at least two years.

Citizens who received secondary special vocational education (nine-year general secondary and three-year secondary special vocational education) before the enactment of this Law are also entitled to receive secondary professional and secondary special professional education.

Vocational schools, colleges, and technical schools ensure that students acquire the profession and specialization of their choice.

Citizens have the right to pursue second *and further professional education on a contractual basis.*

- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is

below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

Yes o No o

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☒ Limited access | ☐ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Low readiness of primary graduates |
| ☐ High dropout rates | ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.3 Higher education. For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3³⁹, and target 4.4⁴⁰. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training.

- Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (*several items may be ticked*):

- ☐ Higher education is free of charge

³⁹ Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”.

⁴⁰ Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

- ☒ Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states
- ☒ Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).
- ☐ Other:

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Article 11. Higher education, , Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan on Education, 1997, (as amended on 2020).

Higher education ensures the training of highly qualified personnel in bachelor's and master's degree programs.

The training of highly educated personnel is carried out in higher education institutions (universities, academies, institutes, and higher schools). Individuals who have received general secondary education (eleven years), secondary special education (nine years of basic secondary and two years of secondary special education), primary professional education (nine years of basic secondary and two years of primary professional education), as well as those who received secondary special or vocational education (nine years of general secondary and three years of secondary special vocational education) before the enactment of this Law, have the right to pursue higher education.

Higher education consists of two stages: bachelor's and master's degrees.

A bachelor's degree provides in-depth knowledge, qualifications, and skills in one of the higher education majors, and the duration of study is at least three years.

A master's degree is higher education based on a relevant bachelor's degree, with a minimum duration of one year of study in a specific specialization.

The list of master's degree specialties and the corresponding bachelor's degree programs is determined by the competent national executive authority in the field of education.

Citizens have the right to pursue second and subsequent higher education based on a contract.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Limited access | ☐ Low number of professionally trained professors |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | |
| ☐ Poor learning outcomes | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

There are governmental and private higher education institutions in the Republic of Uzbekistan. Private higher education institutions began to be established in 2019, and by 2024, their number had reached 70.

The establishment of private higher education institutions in Uzbekistan was introduced to liberalize the higher education system, incorporate diversity in educational services, foster a healthy competitive environment among higher education institutions, and expand opportunities for young people to make choices.

The establishment and operation of private higher education institutions are regulated by the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan "On Education" and other relevant legal documents. Licenses for private higher education institutions are issued by the Ministry of Higher Education, Science, and Innovation of the Republic of Uzbekistan.

Private higher education institutions, like state higher education institutions, strictly prohibit any form of discrimination.

2.4 **Adult education and alternative learning.** *For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.”*

- Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education
- ☐ Provision of literacy programmes

- ☒ Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)
- ☐ Provision of free of charge learning opportunities
- ☒ Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes
- ☒ Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning
- ☐ Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling
- ☐ Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Limited access | ☒ Limited funding |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | ☐ Low number of professionally trained educators |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3. Quality education provision and learning environment .

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to “build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all”.

3.1 General measures

- Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding:

- ☒ State monitoring and inspections
- ☒ Health and sanitation
- ☒ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- ☒ Infrastructure
- ☒ Curriculum
- ☒ Student-teacher ratio
- ☒ School fees (if relevant)
- ☐ Other

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.

Constitution of the Republic of Uzbekistan (adopted on May 1, 2023);

Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On Education” (adopted on September 23, 2020 No. ZRU-637);

Law “On Preschool Education and Upbringing”, 2019.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments | ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials |
| ☐ Violence in schools | ☐ Inadequate parental support to education |
| ☐ Cost of education | ☐ Long distances to schools |
| ☐ Conflicts or crises | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.2 Education personnel . For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Teacher training is provided without discrimination.
- ☒ Teachers’ average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).
- ☒ Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.
- ☐ Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.
- ☒ Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.
- ☒ Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.
- ☒ Establishment of performance monitoring systems.
- ☒ Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Shortages of teaching staff | ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials |
| ☐ Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff | ☐ High student – teacher ratio |
| ☐ Lack of training centres | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.⁴¹ Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked):

☒ Curriculum includes human rights education.

☒ Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.

☐ Other:

As part of the implementation of Presidential Decree 46 on the approval of the National Program for Human Rights Education in the Republic of Uzbekistan, the Ministry of Higher Education introduced educational and special courses on "Human Rights," "Women's Rights," and "Rights of the Child," innovations developed by the Ministry of higher education, science, and innovation of the Republic of Uzbekistan. This curriculum is introduced for students of the Tashkent State Law University, University of world economy and diplomacy, Termez state university, Andijan state university, Namangan state university, Karakalpak state university, Buxara state university, Samarkand state university.

"Legal Issues in Secondary Schools" International Law: Explaining the content of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, the Convention on the Rights of the Child, the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, the Universal Declaration of Human Rights and the Convention on the Political Rights of Women ; National law: Law "On Education", Law "On the Rights of Persons with Disabilities", Law "On Guarantees of Children's Rights" and Resolution No. 638 of October 12, 2021 of the Cabinet of Ministers on Education of Children with Special Educational Needs and Women- educational sessions were held on topics such as studying the guarantees of girls' rights

Training courses on "Combating torture: international practice and national experience" approved by the National Center for human rights, the Prosecutor General's Office, and the Ministry of Internal Affairs on April 4, 2024 have been scheduled. According to the plan, in 2024, Tashkent region (April 30 and May 1), Republic of Karakalpakstan (May 21-22) and Khorezm region (May 23-24), Surkhandarya region (July 2-3), Kashkadarya region (July 4-5), Based on the plan approved in Syrdarya region (July 30-31), Jizzakh (August 1-2), Fergana region (September 16-17), Andijan region (September 18-19), Namangan (September 20-21), national and with the involvement of international experts, online and offline training courses were organized on the topic "Combating torture: international practice and national experience". A total of 630 employees of internal affairs (50 people) and prosecutor's office (10 people) from each region of the investigation, investigation, preliminary investigation bodies, regional judges and penitentiary institutions participated

in the training courses.

The Ministry of Poverty Alleviation and Employment has developed a plan of measures on "Conducting seminars and trainings on the rights of persons with disabilities". In accordance with the approved seminar training program on the rights of persons with disabilities, 2023 special boarding schools for persons with disabilities held a total of 143 seminar-training events on the provisions of the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities

In conjunction with the newly revised Labor Code of the Republic of Uzbekistan, 8 times in the mass media on the labor rights of persons with disabilities, 788 seminars were held in cooperation with district (city) employment assistance departments, district and city governments, and 24,522 participants took part in these seminars and meetings.

In 2023-2024, training course on "International and national mechanisms for the protection of women's rights" topic was organized at the initiative of the National Center of the Republic of Uzbekistan for Human Rights. The training was held in cooperation with the National Agency of Social Protection under the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan and the Republican Center for Rehabilitation and Adaptation of Women. The main goal of the training course is to increase the knowledge of the employees of the Women's Rehabilitation and Adaptation Center about international standards in the field of human rights, international and national mechanisms related to the legal basis of protection of women's rights, recommendations of UN chartered bodies and treaty committees. Directors of the Republican Center for Rehabilitation and Adaptation of Women, its regional departments and exemplary inter-district centers, as well as lawyers of this Center - a total of 92 participants - are participating in the trainings online.

The National Center, in cooperation with the Ministry of Internal Affairs and the Ministry of Poverty Reduction and Employment, developed a program of training courses on the topic "Migrants' rights: international standards and national legislation" and was approved on May 16, 2023. On August 16, 2023, a training course on "Migrants' rights: international standards and national legislation" was organized in cooperation with the National Center, the Ministry of Poverty Alleviation and Employment, the Ministry of Internal Affairs, the Agency for Foreign Labor Migration, and the Law Enforcement Academy. The training courses were focused on improving the knowledge and skills of the employees of the Migration Agency regarding the international and national migration-legal norms that regulate migration rights and relations, the theoretical foundations of the administrative-legal regulation of migration processes, the content and main directions of the state policy in the field of migration at the modern stage. About 100 employees of the central office and regional branches of the Foreign Labor Migration Agency took part in the event.

In order to organize regular training of specialists of state bodies and organizations participating in the fulfillment of the international obligations of the Republic of Uzbekistan in the field of human rights, according to international standards of human rights, the training program "Implementation of obligations in the field of human rights by the Republic of Uzbekistan: practice and report" of the World Education Program in the field of Human Rights in the Republic of Uzbekistan was approved by the chairman of the National Commission on the implementation of the fourth stage on March 27, 2023. In accordance with the program, on November 14-17, 2023, online and offline training courses were organized in the IHMM meeting hall on the topic of "International standards of observance and protection of human rights: practice and reporting". The four-day training was devoted to the 75th anniversary of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.

More than 20 (16 offline and 3 online) specialists of state bodies and organizations participated in the event in offline and online formats. Training courses were organized on the basis of the approved program, presentations and handouts prepared by experts. On May 14-17, 2024, online and offline training courses on "International standards of observance and protection of human rights: practice and reporting" were organized in the meeting hall of IHMM. This training course was dedicated to the 45th anniversary of the United Nations Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women, the 40th anniversary of the Convention against Torture, and the 35th anniversary of the Convention on the Rights of the Child. More than 20 officials of ministries and agencies actively participating in the fulfillment of Uzbekistan's international obligations in the field of human rights participated in the training. Independent practical training was also conducted. Specialists of the National Center presented detailed information about the training courses on the electronic platform for training in the field of Human Rights. Certificates were awarded to students who successfully completed the training course

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

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3.4 Non-state actors in education

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision⁴².

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked):

☒ Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation⁴³ explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:

Article 31. Non-state educational organizations, Law on education of the Republic of Uzbekistan 2020.

Non-state educational organizations, except for educational organizations engaged in extracurricular education, retraining and advanced training, shall carry out their activities on the basis of a license.

(Part one of Article 31 in the wording of the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated October 12, 2021, No. ZRU-721 - National Legislation Database, 12.10.2021, No. 03/21/721/0952.)

Non-state educational organizations shall provide educational services in accordance with the licensing requirements and conditions.

⁴² Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors.

⁴³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

Non-state educational organizations that provide educational services in accordance with state educational standards and state educational requirements shall issue state educational documents to graduates.

Educational organizations rendering non-state educational services on professional development and retraining of personnel may issue to graduates a document on education of the state sample. At the same time, educational organizations providing non-state educational services for professional development and retraining of personnel shall undergo attestation and state accreditation in accordance with the established procedure.

(Article 31 is supplemented with part four by Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. ZRU-721 of October 12, 2021 - National Legislation Database

☒ Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). [Please specify:](#)

☒ Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. [Please specify:](#)

Law on education of the Republic of Uzbekistan 2020.

☒ Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. [Please specify what is covered:](#)

☒ Registration

☒ State monitoring and inspections

☒ Qualifications of teachers

☒ Health and sanitation

☒ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools)

☒ Infrastructure

☒ Curriculum

☒ Student-teacher ratio

- ☐ School fees
- ☒ School closures
- ☐ Other

- Please elaborate:

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials | ☐ Issues in terms of equity and inclusion |
| ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers | ☐ Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity |
| ☐ High student – teacher ratio | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.5 Digital education

Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion⁴⁴.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.

Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:

Resolution The President of the Republic of Uzbekistan
On additional measures to support the training of qualified specialists in the field of digitalization 2024.

⁴⁴ Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment.

- ☒ Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)
- ☒ Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.
- ☒ Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content⁴⁵, including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.
- ☒ Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.
- ☒ Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education
- ☒ Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.
- ☒ A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

Uzbekistan has adopted a Strategy for the Development of Artificial Intelligence Technologies until 2030 (2024).

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways | ☐ Limited access to internet and/or electricity |
| ☐ Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions | ☐ Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.) |
| ☐ inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks | ☐ Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions |
| | ☐ Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale |
| | ☐ Lack of digital skills development for |

⁴⁵ Lack of internet connection, basic infrastructure or devices.

☐ Other:

meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice

☐ Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

4 Strengthening governance systems

For reference: The Education 2030 Framework for Action states "to ensure quality education and conditions for effective education outcomes, governments should strengthen education systems by instituting and improving appropriate, effective and inclusive governance and accountability mechanisms; quality assurance; management information systems; transparent and effective financing procedures and mechanisms; and institutional management arrangements, as well as ensure that robust, timely and accessible data are available" (para. 18).

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked):

☒ Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.

☒ Monitoring results are made public. Please provide the link:

The Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan:
implements a unified state policy in the field of education;
approves and ensures the implementation of state programs in the field of education;
heads the authorized republican executive authorities in the field of education;
<https://uzedu.uz/uz>,
<https://gov.uz/oz/edu>,
<http://www.insonhuquqlari.uz/>

☒ Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.

☐ Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.

☐ Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.

☐ The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.

- ☐ Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.
- ☐ There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

Monitoring in the education system includes the study and monitoring of the state of education, the dynamics of changes in educational outcomes, the conditions created for the implementation of educational activities, as well as the analysis of information about the contingent of students and management decisions.

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance?

- | | |
|---|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ Budgetary constraints ☐ Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels ☐ Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions ☐ Other: | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ Absence of supportive/inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment ☐ Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data |
|---|--|

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

For reference: UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked)

- ☒ Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages

- ☒ Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources
- ☒ Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments
- ☐ Other:

<https://lex.uz/docs/-2686486>

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GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: Uzbekistan

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report: Ministry of Preschool and School Education of the Republic of Uzbekistan

Name of contact person: O.Rakhmatillaev (Mr)

Email and telephone number of contact person: Info@uzedu.uz

I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education¹

- Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

☒ Yes

☐ No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

☐ Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country and whether assistance is needed:

☐ There is interest but no concrete action has been taken

☐ The ratification process has been initiated

☐ The ratification process is close to completion

- Please briefly explain the steps that have been taken and timeline when relevant, any difficulties encountered (legal, institutional, political or practical) in completing the ratification process. And how UNESCO can assist:

“Ratified according to the Resolution of the Oliy Majlis of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated 30.08.1997 No. 497-I On ratification of the Convention against Discrimination in Education”

☐ No, not considering ratification. Please explain why:

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law?

☒ Yes ☐ No

¹ <https://www.unesco.org/en/legal-affairs/convention-against-discrimination-education>

1. Constitution of the Republic of Uzbekistan (adopted on May 1, 2023). 2. Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan "On Education" (adopted on September 23, 2020, No. ZRU-637).

- Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education?²

☐ No

☐ Yes: Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence.

Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the right to education.

"Not available"

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

For reference: This section relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality of educational opportunity as laid out in Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation.

It further corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to "ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all" by 2030. While it covers all the SDG4 targets, it also specifically covers SDG target 4.5.³

- Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

☐ Yes ☐ No

- If yes, please provide reference:

1. Constitution of the Republic of Uzbekistan (adopted on May 1, 2023). 2. Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan "On Education" (adopted on September 23, 2020, No. ZRU-637).

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education

² Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.

³ Which calls on states to "eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations".

- Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation⁴, and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply):

For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b⁵

☐ Legal texts⁶ prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education:

- ☐ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☐ In primary education
- ☐ In secondary education
- ☐ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☐ In higher education
- ☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan "On Education" (adopted on 23.09.2020, No. 3PY-637) Article 4. Basic principles in the field of education The basic principles in the field of education are: recognition of the priority of education; freedom of choice of the form of obtaining education; inadmissibility of discrimination in the field of education; ensuring equal opportunities for obtaining education; introduction of national and universal human values into education and upbringing; humanistic, democratic nature of education and upbringing; continuity and succession of education; compulsory eleven-year education and one-year preparation for general secondary education for children aged six to seven; general accessibility of education within the state educational standards and state educational requirements; unity and differentiation of approach to the choice of curricula; lifelong education; guarantee of social protection of teachers in society; secular nature of the education system; encouragement of education, giftedness and talent; combination of state and public administration in the education system; openness and transparency in the field of educational activity.

Article 5. The right to education Everyone is guaranteed equal rights to obtain education regardless of gender, race, nationality, language, religion, beliefs, social origin, and social status. The right to education is ensured by: the development of educational organizations; support for innovative activities and the implementation of educational programs using innovative technologies in educational organizations; organization of education with (full-time) and without (part-time, evening, distance) separation from production; training, retraining and advanced training of personnel; obtaining free general secondary, secondary specialized and primary vocational education; providing citizens who have received education in the family or through self-education, as well as persons who have not received general secondary education, the right to certification in the form of external studies in accredited state educational institutions. Foreign citizens have the right to receive education in the

⁴ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

⁵ Which calls on states to "substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes".

⁶ Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.

Republic of Uzbekistan in accordance with international treaties and the legislation of the Republic of Uzbekistan. Persons without citizenship permanently residing in the Republic of Uzbekistan have the same rights as citizens of the Republic of Uzbekistan to receive education.

Chapter 2. The system, types and forms of education Article 7. Types of education The types of education are: preschool education and upbringing; general secondary and secondary specialized education; vocational education; higher education; postgraduate education; retraining and advanced training of personnel; extracurricular education.

Article 8. Preschool education and upbringing Preschool education and upbringing is a type of education aimed at teaching and upbringing children, their intellectual, spiritual, moral, ethical, aesthetic and physical development, as well as preparing children for general secondary education. Preschool education and upbringing also provides for the mandatory one-year preparation of children aged six to seven for primary education. The procedure for organizing preschool education and upbringing is determined by this Law, as well as by the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan "On Preschool Education and Upbringing".

Article 9. General secondary and secondary specialized education General secondary and secondary specialized education is aimed at mastering general educational curricula, necessary knowledge, skills and abilities. The stages of general secondary education (grades I - XI) are: primary education (grades I - IV); basic secondary education (grades V - IX); secondary education (grades X - XI). Children are admitted to the first grade of a general secondary educational organization in the year they reach the age of seven. Primary education is aimed at forming students' basic literacy, knowledge, skills and abilities necessary for continuing general secondary education. Basic secondary education provides students with the necessary amount of knowledge, skills and abilities in accordance with the curriculum, develops their independent thinking and analytical abilities. Within the framework of basic secondary education (after grade VII), measures are taken to form students' initial knowledge and skills in professions for professional diagnostics and orientation. Secondary education ensures that students master the necessary knowledge, skills and abilities in accordance with the curriculum, as well as the choice of subsequent type of education and mastering professions that do not require high qualifications. The procedure for organizing professional diagnostics and orientation, as well as the training of students in professions that do not require high qualifications, is established by the legislation. General secondary education is carried out in general secondary educational organizations continuously, for the mandatory eleven years. Secondary specialized education is carried out for two years on the basis of nine-year basic secondary education in academic lyceums and provides for the accelerated development of intellectual abilities, as well as in-depth, differentiated, professionally and personally-oriented education of students. Non-state general secondary educational organizations organize their activities on the basis of a license in accordance with the state educational standard. General secondary and secondary specialized education in non-state educational organizations can be carried out on a paid contractual basis. For the development of the abilities of gifted and talented children, Presidential, creative and other specialized schools, as well as boarding schools, may be established. Children with physical, mental, sensory (sensory) or mental disorders, as well as children in need of long-term treatment, receive education in state specialized educational institutions, general secondary and secondary specialized educational organizations in an inclusive form or individually

at home. The number of students in classes (groups) of general secondary and secondary specialized educational organizations should not exceed thirty-five.

Article 10. Vocational education Vocational education in the acquired profession and specialty includes the following levels: initial vocational education; secondary vocational education; secondary specialized vocational education. Initial vocational education is carried out in vocational schools on the basis of graduates of grade IX on the basis of two-year integrated curricula of general education subjects and specialty subjects in full-time free of charge. Secondary vocational education is carried out in colleges on the basis of general secondary, secondary specialized and initial vocational education in full-time, part-time and correspondence forms of education lasting up to two years, depending on the complexity of professions and specialties on the basis of the state order or paid contract. Secondary specialized vocational education is carried out in technical schools on the basis of general secondary, secondary specialized, initial vocational and secondary vocational education in full-time, part-time and correspondence forms of education lasting at least two years, depending on the complexity of professions and specialties on the basis of the state order or paid contract. Citizens who received secondary specialized, vocational education (nine-year general secondary and three-year secondary specialized, vocational education) before the entry into force of this Law also have the right to receive secondary vocational and secondary specialized vocational education. Vocational schools, colleges and technical schools provide students with the chosen profession and specialty. Citizens have the right to receive a second and subsequent vocational education on a contractual basis.

Article 11. Higher education Higher education provides for the training of highly qualified personnel in the areas of bachelor's education and master's specialties. Training of personnel with higher education is carried out in higher educational organizations (universities, academies, institutes, higher schools). The right to higher education is granted to persons with general secondary (eleven-year education), secondary specialized (nine-year basic secondary and two-year secondary specialized education), initial vocational education (nine-year basic secondary and two-year initial vocational education), as well as persons who received secondary specialized, vocational education (nine-year general secondary and three-year secondary specialized, vocational education) before the entry into force of this Law. Higher education has two levels - bachelor's and master's. Bachelor's degree is the basic higher education, providing in-depth knowledge, skills and abilities in one of the areas of higher education, with a study duration of at least three years. Master's degree is higher education in a specific specialty based on the corresponding bachelor's degree with a study duration of at least one year. The list of master's specialties and the corresponding areas of bachelor's education is determined by the authorized republican executive body in the field of education. Citizens have the right to receive a second and subsequent higher education on a contractual basis.

Article 12. Postgraduate education Postgraduate education can be obtained in higher educational and scientific organizations. Postgraduate education provides for the training of scientific and scientific-pedagogical personnel with an academic degree on the basis of basic doctoral studies, doctoral studies and independent research, providing for in-depth study of specialties and conducting scientific research in order to prepare and defend a doctoral dissertation. Basic doctoral studies is a form of postgraduate education in the specialty of highly qualified scientific and scientific-pedagogical personnel for applicants for the degree of Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) with separation from production. Doctoral studies is a form of postgraduate

education in the specialty of highly qualified scientific and scientific-pedagogical personnel for applicants for the degree of Doctor of Science (DSc) with separation from production. Independent research is a form of postgraduate education in the specialty of highly qualified scientific and scientific-pedagogical personnel for applicants for the degrees of Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) or Doctor of Science (DSc) without separation from production. The procedure for training scientific and scientific-pedagogical personnel, awarding academic degrees and academic titles, as well as the specifics of obtaining postgraduate education in military, medical and other educational organizations, are determined by the legislation. The duration of postgraduate education is determined by the legislation.

Article 14. Extracurricular education To meet the needs of children, organize their free time and recreation, state bodies, non-governmental non-profit organizations, as well as commercial organizations, can create extracurricular educational organizations of cultural, aesthetic, scientific, technical, and sports orientation. Extracurricular education as an integral part of the continuous education of children is aimed at developing their talents and abilities, meeting their spiritual needs. Extracurricular educational organizations include palaces, houses, clubs and centers of children's and youth creativity, children's schools of the "Barkamol Avlod" type, children's and youth sports schools, children's schools of music and art, studios, information, library and health institutions. The procedure for providing extracurricular education is determined by the authorized state administration body in the field of education.

Article 15. Forms of obtaining education The forms of obtaining education are: education with separation from production (full-time); education without separation from production (part-time, evening, distance); dual education; family education and self-education; adult learning and education; inclusive education; education in the form of external studies; training of personnel in the field of defense, security and law enforcement.

Article 19. Adult learning and education Adult learning and education are central components of lifelong learning, which include all forms of education and training aimed at ensuring the participation of adults in the life of society and work, and also cover the entire set of processes of formal, non-formal and informal education. Formal education is institutionalized (embodying certain rules and norms), purposeful and planned with the participation of state educational institutions and accredited non-state educational organizations. Non-formal education is institutionalized (embodying certain rules and norms), purposeful and planned by a person or organization providing educational services, and is a supplement and (or) an alternative to formal education in lifelong learning of the individual. Informal education is purposeful, but non-institutionalized (not embodying certain rules and norms), less organized and structured than formal or non-formal education and can include learning activities in the family, at the workplace, at the place of residence and in everyday life.

Article 20. Inclusive education Inclusive education is aimed at ensuring equal access to education in educational organizations for all students, taking into account the diversity of special educational needs and individual capabilities. Inclusive education is organized in educational organizations for children (persons) with physical, mental, sensory (sensory) or mental disorders. The procedure for organizing inclusive education is determined by the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan.

Article 38. Admission to educational organizations Admission to educational organizations for all applicants is carried out on the basis of the principle of ensuring equal opportunities for obtaining education, except for certain categories of persons who may be granted benefits in accordance with the legislation. Educational organizations are obliged to familiarize applicants and (or) their parents or other legal representatives with the charter, license or confirmation of receipt of a notification (for non-state educational organizations), a certificate of state accreditation (except for non-state educational organizations providing extracurricular educational services), the curriculum and other documents regulating educational activities, the rights and obligations of students. Children with physical, mental, sensory (sensory) or mental disorders are admitted to study with the consent of their parents or other legal representatives and the conclusion of the medical, psychological and pedagogical commission. Admission to certain educational organizations (higher educational organizations, academic lyceums, Presidential, creative, specialized schools and others) is carried out on a competitive basis. When enrolling in educational organizations on a competitive basis, participants in the competition are provided with information on the procedure for conducting the competition. Admission to state higher and vocational educational organizations is carried out on the basis of a state grant and (or) a paid contract. The procedure for admission to state educational institutions and organizations is established by the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan. The procedure for admission to non-state educational organizations is established by these educational organizations, taking into account the provisions provided for by the current regulatory legal acts on admission to educational organizations. The admission of foreign citizens to state educational institutions of the Republic of Uzbekistan is carried out on the basis of a paid contract (except for cases of granting a state grant). The parameters of admission to higher educational organizations on the basis of a state grant are established by the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan. When enrolling in higher educational organizations for the privileged contingent, additional admission parameters are established.

Chapter 6. Rights and obligations of students, their parents and other legal representatives Article 47. Rights of students Students have the right to: receive general secondary, secondary specialized and initial vocational education free of charge; admission to a state general secondary educational institution at their place of residence (microdistrict); freedom of choice of forms of obtaining education; receiving quality education that meets state educational standards, state educational requirements and curricula; receiving the necessary conditions for learning, created taking into account their psychological characteristics and physiological development, as well as receiving free psychological and medical services; participation in the formation of the content of their education, developed in accordance with the requirements of state educational standards of vocational and higher education, in accordance with the procedure established by the state educational institution; protection of life and health from any physical and psychological violence, insults to the personality by teaching staff and other participants in the educational process; vacations for rest and other social needs during the period of education; receiving academic leave and scholarships, restoration of education and transfer to other educational organizations, from one form of education, profession, field of education, specialty to another; participation in the discussion of issues related to the management of the educational organization; free use of the services of educational, methodological, scientific, production, cultural, sports and household facilities of the educational organization in the process of obtaining education; participation in research, experimental design,

scientific, technical, experimental and innovative activities of the educational organization. Students may have other rights in accordance with the legislation. The involvement of students in work unrelated to obtaining education is prohibited in educational organizations.

Chapter 7. Social protection of participants in the educational process Article 52. Social protection of students Students in educational organizations are provided with benefits, scholarships and temporary accommodation in accordance with the legislation. Students on a paid contractual basis may be provided with preferential bank loans. Non-state educational organizations carry out social protection of students in accordance with the legislation, the charter and (or) other constituent documents. The state, in order to ensure social protection, creates conditions for children from low-income families, children (persons) with physical, mental, sensory disorders and children in need of social rehabilitation.

Teachers of educational organizations are established with a reduced working time, are provided with annual extended paid leave and other benefits and guarantees. Pedagogical and other workers of educational organizations are guaranteed health protection, carried out by sanitary, hygienic, anti-epidemic and preventive measures. Educational organizations, within the limits of available funds for remuneration, have the right to independently establish differentiated bonuses to salaries, official salaries and apply various forms of remuneration and incentives.

Article 54. Training and full provision of orphans and children left without parental care or other legal representatives The training and full provision of orphans and children left without parental care or other legal representatives is carried out at the expense of the State Budget of the Republic of Uzbekistan.

Article 55. Education and upbringing of children (persons) with physical, mental, sensory (sensory) or mental disorders The state provides free general secondary, secondary specialized, vocational and extracurricular education for children (persons) with physical, mental, sensory (sensory) or mental disorders in state specialized educational institutions, general secondary, secondary specialized and vocational educational institutions in an inclusive form. State specialized educational institutions are created for the education and upbringing of children with physical, mental, sensory (sensory) or mental disorders, as well as those in need of long-term treatment. The referral of students to these educational institutions and their expulsion from them is carried out based on the conclusion of the medical, psychological and pedagogical commission with the consent of the parents or other legal representatives. Students of state specialized educational institutions are under state maintenance.

Article 56. Education and upbringing of children (persons) in need of social rehabilitation Specialized educational and upbringing institutions are created for children (persons) in need of special conditions for education and upbringing, providing for their education, vocational training and social rehabilitation. Conditions for obtaining education, upbringing and self-education are created for children (persons) held in institutions for the execution of punishment in the form of imprisonment.

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:

☐ Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education

☐ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

☐ In primary education

☐ In secondary education

☐ In technical and vocational education and training

☐ In higher education

☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

In the education system, in secondary general education institutions, education is conducted in 7 languages (Uzbek, Russian, Karakalpak, Turkmen, Tajik, Kazakh, Kyrgyz). For the 2024-2025 academic year, there are 9,445 schools with Uzbek as the language of instruction with 5,600,619 students, 380 schools with Karakalpak as the language of instruction with 124,726 students, 946 schools with Russian as the language of instruction with 685,334 students, 237 schools with Tajik as the language of instruction with 64,832 students, 46 schools with Kyrgyz as the language of instruction with 7,345 students, 354 schools with Kazakh as the language of instruction with 48,666 students, and 43 schools with Turkmen as the language of instruction with 10,971 students. The total number of students is 6,542,493, of which 3,215,066 are girls.

☐ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum:

☐ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

☐ In primary education

☐ In secondary education

☐ In technical and vocational education and training

☐ In higher education

☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

The Ministry of Preschool and School Education, its regional departments, and district (city) departments have created special sections in social networks aimed at raising awareness about the elimination of any forms of discrimination. Advocacy events with the participation of psychologists are constantly organized in general education schools.

- ☐ Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

1.2 Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education

- Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (*several items may be ticked*):

General measures:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Legislation provides for inclusive education for all | ☐ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ⁸ are provided for |
| ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all | ☐ Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design ⁹ |
| ☐ Teachers are trained on inclusive education ⁷ and to value diversity | ☐ Multilingual and intercultural education is supported |
| ☐ Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance | |
- ☐ Other:

At the state level, work has begun in the republic to create a mechanism for social support of children with special educational needs and to form the corresponding legislative framework. Today, great attention is paid to ensuring the active integration of children with special educational needs into society and expanding the practice of inclusive education. According to the Constitution of the Republic of Uzbekistan, "inclusive education and upbringing are provided for children with special educational needs in educational organizations". The goal of inclusive education is to create a barrier-free learning environment for students with special educational needs through the use of special means and methods in schools with the involvement of special teachers, providing quality general secondary education that serves their effective adaptation in society and full integration. The Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan "On Education" (adopted on 23.09.2020, No. 3PY-637) defines "Inclusive Education" (Chapter 2, Article 20), "Social Protection of Students" (Chapter 7, Article 52), "Education and Upbringing of Children (Persons) with Physical, Mental, Sensory (Sensory) or Mental Disorders" (Chapter 7, Article 55), and "Education and Upbringing of Children (Persons) in Need of Social Rehabilitation" (Chapter 7, Article 56) in separate chapters.

⁷ Teachers are prepared to teach all student (beyond just students with disabilities), equipping them with knowledge, values and attitudes that permit every student to succeed. See: [UNESCO policy paper](#): Inclusive teaching: preparing all teachers to teach all students, 2020, p.14.

⁸ Multiple and flexible learning pathways are 'entry points and re-entry points at all ages and all educational levels, strengthened links between formal and non-formal structures, and recognition, validation and accreditation of the knowledge, skills and competencies acquired through nonformal and informal education' ([Education 2030 Framework for Action](#), para. 33). This may include student transfers between courses and institutions and diverse learning modalities (online, in-person, full-time, part-time, etc.) to respond to individual needs and interests.

⁹ In designing the curricula and teaching methods, care is given to ensure that all students are provided with an inclusive and supportive learning experience that offers them the opportunity to succeed whatever their background.

According to the Law, inclusive education is aimed at ensuring equal access to education in educational organizations for all students, taking into account the diversity of special educational needs and individual capabilities, in particular, it is being introduced for children (persons) with physical, mental, sensory (sensory) or mental disorders in educational organizations.

The legislative framework for the implementation of inclusive education is also the Decree of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated October 13, 2020, No. PP-4860 "On Measures for Further Improvement of the Education and Upbringing System for Children with Special Educational Needs".

According to this document:

- A "Roadmap" has been developed for the implementation of the Concept of Development of Inclusive Education in the Public Education System in 2020-2025 in 2020-2021;
- Target indicators (indicators) for the development of education for children with special educational needs until 2025 have been defined, where step-by-step measures for the introduction of inclusive education are outlined;
- A step-by-step implementation based on a separate "Roadmap" is defined, which is approved annually, starting from 2022, based on the achieved results, target indicators and main directions for the corresponding period;
- It is planned to conduct constant monitoring of the implementation of "roadmaps" and target indicators (indicators) with a critical review of its results once a year at the government level.

Also, by the decision of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. 46 "On Measures to Improve the Education and Rehabilitation System for Children with Special Educational Needs", adopted on January 25, 2024, unified psychological, medical and pedagogical commissions have been created in the territorial departments of the National Agency for Social Protection of the Population under the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan. These commissions are responsible for directing children with special educational needs to state educational institutions. Since February 2024, based on the conclusion of the psychological, medical and pedagogical commission, more than 10,000 children with special educational needs have been covered by education.

In addition, since 2024, the International Inclusive Hub international basic center of inclusive vocational education has been launched in Tashkent. This center has created equal opportunities for obtaining quality education, realizing one's talents, and choosing modern and promising professions for the rehabilitation and adaptation of young people to society. A number of educational programs related to the fields of art and information technology have been opened here.

In recent years, as a result of changes in the field of education, inclusive education has been widely introduced. Legislative documents in this direction are being improved. The first schools have appeared in Uzbekistan where all students can receive equal education. Currently, there are 715 inclusive schools in the republic, in which 1,195 students with special educational needs study.

These schools are improving the quality of education for children with disabilities. This helps children with disabilities fully realize their talent and potential. The existing infrastructure in educational institutions has also been improved.

According to the Ministry of Preschool and School Education of the Republic of Uzbekistan, as of January 1, 2024, 21,056 children are studying in specialized schools and boarding schools (90 specialized schools) for children with physical and mental disabilities, of which 727 children are studying in 3 specialized boarding schools for children with musculoskeletal disorders, 4,873 children are studying in 19 specialized boarding schools for children with hearing impairments, and 14,955 are receiving individual education at home.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

1. The CONSTITUTION OF THE REPUBLIC OF UZBEKISTAN (adopted on 01.05.2023)
2. The Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On Education” (adopted on 23.09.2020, No. 3PY-637)
3. The Decree of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated October 13, 2020, No. PP-4860 “On Measures for Further Improvement of the Education and Upbringing System for Children with Special Educational Needs”
4. The Resolution of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. 46 “On Measures to Improve the Education and Rehabilitation System for Children with Special Educational Needs”, adopted on January 25, 2024
5. The Resolution of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated September 5, 2018 No. PP-3931 “On Measures to Introduce New Principles of Management in the Public Education System” which outlines specific tasks for further improving the effectiveness of measures to ensure social guarantees for children with special educational needs, as well as for creating an adaptive environment serving their education and upbringing (in particular, inclusive education and upbringing).
6. The Resolution of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan, dated 12.10.2021, No. 638 “On Approval of Regulatory Legal Acts Concerning the Education of Children with Special Educational Needs”.

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Legislation provides for gender equality in education | ☐ All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education |
| ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality | ☐ Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for |
| ☐ Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken | ☐ Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities ¹¹ |
| ☐ Providing positive or affirmative action measures | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ¹² and bias |
| ☐ Providing financial incentives and fellowships | ☐ Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) |
| ☐ Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality | ☐ Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET) |

¹¹ ‘Gender-sensitive sanitation includes clean, safe and separate toilets, with access to water and garbage disposal’ ([UNGEI blog post](#), Gender-sensitive sanitation, 2018)

¹² Stereotype is a set idea that people have about what someone or something is like, especially an idea that is wrong’ (Cambridge Dictionary).

☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation¹⁰

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

no

- What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

none

- Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) ¹³:

Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

The FAMILY CODE OF THE REPUBLIC OF UZBEKISTAN. Article 15. Marriageable age.

National minorities:

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities.

☐ Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities

☐ Teachers are trained on intercultural education

☐ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities

☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation¹⁵

¹⁰ ‘ Stigmatisation is the act of treating someone or something unfairly by publicly disapproving of them’ (Cambridge Dictionary).

¹³ Please note that according to the Joint general recommendation No. 31 of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women/general comment No. 18 of the Committee on the Rights of the Child on harmful practice, para. 20: “a marriage of a mature, capable child below 18 years of age may be allowed in exceptional circumstances, provided that the child is at least 16 years of age and that such decisions are made by a judge based on legitimate exceptional grounds defined by law and on the evidence of maturity, without deference to culture and tradition.”

¹⁵ Supra note 15.

☐ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities

☐ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities

☐ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities

☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities

☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities

☐ Other¹⁴:

no

☐ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported

☐ Native language instruction is ensured for national minorities

☐ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities

☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes¹⁶ and bias

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

no

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

none

Indigenous people:

☐ Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people

☐ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people

☐ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities

☐ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people

☐ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people

☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people

☐ Teachers are trained on intercultural education

☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation¹⁷

☐ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported

☐ Native language instruction is ensured

☐ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people

☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes¹⁸ and bias

¹⁴ Please see: [UNESCO report](#) 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023.

¹⁶ Supra note 16.

¹⁷ Supra note 15.

¹⁸ Supra note 16.

☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people

☐ Other:

none

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

none

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

none

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations¹⁹:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for |
| ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☐ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☐ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☐ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ²² are provided |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²³ and bias |
| ☐ All administrative barriers to access education are removed | ☐ Accelerated learning programmes are provided |
| ☐ Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers ²⁰ are provided for | ☐ Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided |
| ☐ Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion | ☐ Language classes to newcomers are provided for |
| ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²¹ | ☐ Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged |
| ☐ Other: | |

¹⁹ 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' ([UNESCO report](#): The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2).

²⁰ While lack of documentation (such as identity papers, birth certificates, residency permits, etc.) should not be an obstacle to access education, these can constitute a barrier to education See: [UNESCO publication](#): Handbook on the right to education, 2018, p. 96.

²¹ Supra note 15.

²² Supra note 13

²³ Supra note 16.

none

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please elaborate:

none

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

People with disabilities:

☐ Legislation provides for their right to education

☐ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education

☐ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured

☐ Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools

☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided

☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided

☐ Other

☐ Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities

☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation²⁴

☐ Auxiliary assistance is provided

☐ Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted

☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes²⁵ and bias

☐ Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

1. CONSTITUTION OF THE REPUBLIC OF UZBEKISTAN (adopted on 01.05.2023)
2. Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan "On Education" (adopted on 23.09.2020, No. 3PY-637)
3. Decree of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated October 13, 2020, No. PP-4860 "On Measures for Further Improvement of the Education and Upbringing System for Children with Special Educational Needs"

²⁴ Supra note 15.

²⁵ Supra note 16.

4. Resolution of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. 46 “On Measures to Improve the Education and Rehabilitation System for Children with Special Educational Needs”, adopted on January 25, 2024
5. Resolution of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated September 5, 2018 No. PP-3931 “On Measures to Introduce New Principles of Management in the Public Education System” which outlines specific tasks for further improving the effectiveness of measures to ensure social guarantees for children with special educational needs, as well as for creating an adaptive environment serving their education and upbringing (in particular, inclusive education and upbringing)
6. Resolution of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan, dated 12.10.2021, No. 638 “On Approval of Regulatory Legal Acts Concerning the Education of Children with Special Educational Needs”

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

none

Students from poor households:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁶ |
| ☐ Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²⁷ and bias |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided | |
| ☐ Other: | |

(Information can be obtained from the National Agency for Social Protection.)

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

²⁶ Supra note 15.

²⁷ Supra note 16.

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education

2.1 Early childhood care and education

For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation²⁸ and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education²⁹. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked):

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free | ☐ ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play. |
| ☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable | |
| ☐ ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis | |

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

In state preschool education institutions that are not fully operational and have vacant group rooms, based on the existing needs of the population, paid educational services have been organized for their children aged 2 to 3 years.

In particular, in 6 state preschool education institutions in Tashkent, 8 paid education and upbringing groups for children aged 2 to 3 years have been organized.

- Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available?

☐ Pre-primary education is compulsory. Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:

Article 6 of the Law No.-595 of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated December 16, 2019 stipulates that the state guarantees the right of each child to undergo mandatory one-year preparation for general secondary education in state preschool educational institutions one year before entering the general secondary educational institution.

In the regions of the republic, 7,601 free mandatory one-year preparatory groups for primary education have been organized for 6-year-old children who are not covered, covering 182,256 children.

²⁸ Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”.
²⁹ Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE”

☐ Pre-primary education is **not** compulsory.

☐ Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:

Article 6 of the Law No. -595 of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated December 16, 2019 establishes the following regarding the organization of preschool education:

Every child has the right to receive preschool education and upbringing.

The state guarantees the right of each child to undergo mandatory one-year preparation for general secondary education in state preschool educational institutions one year before entering the general secondary educational institution.

The state guarantees for the child's preschool education and upbringing are ensured through the provision of preschool education and upbringing services on the basis of state preschool educational institutions, as well as the organization of alternative forms of education and upbringing.

Children aged 3 to 7 years are covered free of charge in the small, medium, large and school-preparatory groups of preschool educational institutions.

Currently, 2,289,900 out of 3,052,970 children in the republic, i.e. 75%, are covered by 38,233 preschool educational institutions. Of these, 1,126,631 (49.2%) are girls.

Additionally, 7,601 free one-year mandatory preparatory groups for primary education have been organized for 6-year-old children who are not covered, covering 182,256 children.

At the same time, within the framework of the "Intelligent" project, 429 mobile groups have been organized in 156 neighborhoods in remote and mountainous areas where it is impossible to build preschool educational institutions, covering 9,500 children.

In cooperation with UNICEF, 20 "Mixed-age Preschool Education Groups" (play groups) have been organized as an alternative form of preschool education in Namangan and Khorezm regions, covering a total of 496 children.

Within the framework of the "Assistance in the Early Development of Children" project in cooperation with the World Bank, 3 model "Early Development Centers" are operating in Namangan and Samarkand regions, covering a total of 1,812 children.

The Tashkent Declaration is aimed at defining the international agenda for early childhood education until 2030, and includes a number of key principles, including:

First, improving the quality and relevance of curricula and pedagogy in preschool education;

Second, ensuring equal and inclusive educational services for all children, including protecting and guaranteeing the rights of young children to education and upbringing in emergency situations;

Third, developing and supporting teaching staff;

Fourth, widely introducing innovations in the field;

Fifth, state support for the system.

Based on these and other tasks, the main factors for the coming years are to gradually cover children with preschool education, improve the potential of teaching staff, widely introduce innovations and state support for the sector.

Today, based on the tasks set, the goals of achieving full coverage of children with preschool education by 2030 and full coverage of 6-year-old children with school preparatory groups have been defined in our country.

☐ Pre-primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education?

☐ Limited access

☐ Poor learning outcomes

☐ Issues of equity and inclusion

☐ Low number of professionally trained educators

☐ Poor quality programmes

☐ Lack of support to families

☐ Other:

In order to organize the educational process in preschool educational institutions and improve its quality, the “First Step” state program was developed and implemented, taking into account international experience. This program establishes uniform standards.

Based on the “First Step” state program, the “Ilm Yuli” variable curriculum has been developed to organize the educational process in the preparatory groups for 6-year-old children. Additionally, preschool educational institutions are provided with educational, methodological and didactic materials at the expense of the budget, which serves to further improve the quality of education in these institutions.

At the same time, in order to organize continuous methodological support for the pedagogical staff working in the preschool education system, the “Learning passport” (Childhood Academy - bolakadem.uz) educational electronic platform has been introduced.

In addition, the “Bebbo” mobile application has been launched for parents, which provides specialist advice on all aspects of the health and development of children up to 6 years of age.

Currently, there are no problems in organizing the educational process with preschool children.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.2 Primary and secondary education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide “12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory.”

Primary education

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education:

The primary education age is 7-11 years and the duration is 4 years (grades 1-4).

- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge?

☒ Primary education is compulsory

☐ Primary education is **not** compulsory.

☒ Primary education is free of charge.

☐ Primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

According to Article 50 of the Education Constitution of Uzbekistan, everyone has the right to receive education.
The state ensures the development of the continuous education system, its various types and forms, as well as state and non-state educational institutions.
The state guarantees free general secondary education and initial vocational education. General secondary education is compulsory.
Preschool education and upbringing, as well as general secondary education, are under state control.
Inclusive education and upbringing are provided in educational institutions for children with special educational needs.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education?

☐ Limited access

☐ Issues of equity and inclusion

☐ High dropout rates

☐ Poor quality programmes

☐ Other:

☐ Poor learning outcomes in:

Foundation literacy

Numeracy

Social and emotional learning

Others

- ☐ Disparity in learning outcomes
- ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers

The Education Law stipulates that school-age children are enrolled in the state general secondary educational institution in their place of residence (micro-district).

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Secondary education

In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:

The primary education age is 7-10 years and the duration is 4 years (grades 1-4).

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:

The secondary education age is 16-17 years and the duration is 2 years (grades 10-11).

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge?

☒ Lower secondary education is compulsory.

☐ Lower secondary education is **not** compulsory.

☒ Lower secondary education is free of charge.

☐ Lower secondary education is **not** free of charge.

☐ Upper secondary education is compulsory.

☐ Upper secondary education is **not** compulsory.

☐ Upper secondary education is free of charge

☐ Upper secondary education is **not** free of charge.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

According to Article 50 of the Education Constitution of Uzbekistan, everyone has the right to receive education. The state ensures the development of the continuous education system, its various types and forms, as well as state and non-state educational institutions. The state

guarantees free general secondary education and initial vocational education. General secondary education is compulsory. Preschool education and upbringing, as well as general secondary education, are under state control. Inclusive education and upbringing are provided in educational institutions for children with special educational needs.

- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

Yes o No o

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:

In Uzbekistan, the working age for able-bodied men is set from 16 to 60 years, and for women from 16 to 55 years. This minimum age for work coincides with the end of the mandatory education period.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Low readiness of primary graduates |
| ☐ High dropout rates | ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | |
| ☐ Other: | |

According to Article 50 of the Education Constitution of Uzbekistan, general secondary education is compulsory.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.3 Higher education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3³⁰, and target 4.4³¹. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training.

- Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (*several items may be ticked*):

- ☐ Higher education is free of charge
- ☐ Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states
- ☐ Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).
- ☐ Other:

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Low number of professionally trained professors |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | |
| ☐ Poor learning outcomes | |
| ☐ Other: | |

³⁰ Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”.

³¹ Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.”

- Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (*several items may be ticked*):

- ☐ Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education
- ☐ Provision of literacy programmes
- ☐ Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)
- ☐ Provision of free of charge learning opportunities
- ☐ Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes
- ☐ Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning
- ☐ Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling
- ☐ Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Limited funding |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Poor learning outcomes |

☐ Poor quality programmes

☐ Low number of professionally trained educators

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3. Quality education provision and learning environment

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to “build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all”.

3.1 General measures

- Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding:

☐ State monitoring and inspections

☐ Health and sanitation

☐ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))

☐ Infrastructure

☐ Curriculum

☐ Student-teacher ratio

☐ School fees (if relevant)

☐ Other

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.

The Law on Education, the Law on Guarantees of Children's Rights, as well as the Decree of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On Measures to Further Improve the System of Ensuring Guarantees of Children's Rights” dated August 9, 2021, No. PF-6275, and the Resolution of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On Approving Normative Legal Documents on Educating Children with Special Educational Needs” dated October 12, 2021, No. 638, along with other normative legal documents, stipulate that students are provided with safe and quality conditions for obtaining education.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments | ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials |
| ☐ Violence in schools | ☐ Inadequate parental support to education |
| ☐ Cost of education | ☐ Long distances to schools |
| ☐ Conflicts or crises | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.2 Education personnel

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Teacher training is provided without discrimination.
- ☐ Teachers’ average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).
- ☐ Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.
- ☐ Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.
- ☐ Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.
- ☐ Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.
- ☐ Establishment of performance monitoring systems.
- ☐ Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

Teacher preparation and their social status: key aspects

1. Access to education and equal opportunities Teacher preparation is carried out without any discrimination, ensuring equal opportunities for everyone, regardless of gender. Education is accessible to all, and the teaching profession is open to both women and men.
2. Salaries and attractiveness of the profession The average salaries of teachers in the regions are competitive compared to other professions. Although in the central cities the teaching profession may be less attractive due to relatively low salaries and overcrowded classes, it remains in demand in the regions.
3. Initial training system and qualification standards
 - Initial (pre-service) training is provided for all prospective teachers.
 - In 2020, minimum standards (teacher professional standards) and qualification requirements were adopted, which contributes to improving the quality of teacher training.
4. Measures to strengthen the social status of teachers
 - A law on teachers, aimed at strengthening their social status, has been adopted and signed by the President.
 - Work is underway to improve working conditions and increase the prestige of the profession.
5. Gender balance There is no gender imbalance in the legislation. Measures to ensure equality are implemented both at the level of teacher training and in their professional activities.

Gender balance and women's leadership in education

1. Current situation There is a significant gender imbalance in the education sector:
 - 78% of teachers are women, indicating the dominance of women in the profession.
 - However, only 32% of school principals are women, indicating insufficient representation of women in leadership positions.
2. Factors influencing the gender imbalance Gender inequality in educational leadership is due to several reasons:
 - Cultural stereotypes: The mentality, according to which leadership positions for women are not always approved in families.
 - Financial and geographical limitations: The requirement to undergo certification courses in the capital creates difficulties for women from remote regions.
 - Workload: School principals often work more than 8 hours a day and bear significant responsibility, making this work less attractive for women, especially with family responsibilities.
 - Social pressure: In some families and communities, the aspiration of women for career growth is not encouraged.
3. Requirements for obtaining the position of principal To become a school principal or confirm this status, it is necessary:
 - To undergo certification courses for the title of educational leader.
 - The courses are held in the capital, which creates additional barriers for women from the regions. This requirement does not always take into account gender sensitivity and can exacerbate existing inequalities.
4. Measures to eliminate the imbalance Work is underway to create conditions that contribute to increasing the number of women in leadership positions, including:
 - Development of gender-sensitive approaches in certification and appointment procedures.
 - Simplifying the accessibility of courses for women from the regions (for example, through distance learning).
 - Raising awareness and overcoming cultural stereotypes.
 - Creating support programs for women leaders, including mentoring and professional development.

Addressing the gender imbalance requires systemic changes that take into account cultural, financial, and demographic aspects. Only a comprehensive approach will allow for equal participation of women in educational leadership.

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel?

- ☐ Shortages of teaching staff
- ☐ Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff
- ☐ Lack of training centres
- ☐ Other:
- ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials
- ☐ High student – teacher ratio

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.³² Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Curriculum includes human rights education.
- ☐ Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.
- ☐ Other:

Youth organizations in neighborhoods are implementing educational projects to encourage young people;

Online educational platforms have been created to improve the literacy of young people.

³²

Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

1. Conducting legal literacy classes in secondary schools using interactive methods to form a legal culture from childhood.
2. Instilling a legal culture in youth, including the concepts of equality between women and men, creating animated short films and social videos aimed at fostering a sense of intolerance for violence.
3. Holding meetings on the topic “Do you know your rights and responsibilities?” among young people as part of the “Day of Crime Prevention” held every Thursday.
4. Holding a human rights week to raise awareness and information about human rights. Within the framework of the week, information on various topics such as children's rights, gender equality, religious freedom, freedom of speech and others is provided.

3.4 Non-state actors in education

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision³³.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked):

☐ Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation³⁴ explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:

☐ Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:

☐ Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:

³³ Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors.

³⁴ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

☐ Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. [Please specify what is covered:](#)

☐ Registration

☐ State monitoring and inspections

☐ Qualifications of teachers

☐ Health and sanitation

☐ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))

☐ Infrastructure

☐ Curriculum

☐ Student-teacher ratio

☐ School fees

☐ School closures

☐ Other

[- Please elaborate:](#)

[- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision?](#)

☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials

☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers

☐ High student – teacher ratio

☐ Other:

☐ Issues in terms of equity and inclusion

☐ Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity

[- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.](#)

3.5 Digital education

Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion³⁵.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked):

☐ Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.

Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:

“Digital Uzbekistan – 2030” Strategy Approved by the Decree of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated October 5, 2020 No. UP-6079. The strategy is aimed at accelerating the development of the digital industry, increasing the competitiveness of the national economy and introducing digital technologies in various areas, including education.

The Concept of Introducing “Smart City” Technologies Approved by the Resolution of the Cabinet of Ministers dated January 18, 2019 No. 48. Within the framework of this concept, “Smart Education” is considered as the introduction of innovative technologies, including educational online platforms and massive open online courses, which contributes to the digitalization of the educational process.

Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On Education” Adopted on September 23, 2020. The law defines the basic concepts and directions of development of the education system, including the use of digital technologies to improve the quality and accessibility of educational services.

☐ Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)

☐ Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.

☐ Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content³⁶, including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.

☐ Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.

³⁵ Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children’s right to education in relation to the digital environment.

³⁶ Lack of internet connection, basic infrastructure or devices.

☐ Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education

☐ Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.

☐ A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)?

☐ Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways

☐ Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions

☐ inadequate safety measures and IT

support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks

☐ Other:

☐ Limited access to internet and/or electricity

☐ Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.)

☐ Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions

☐ Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale

☐ Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice

☐ Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

4 Strengthening governance systems

For reference: The Education 2030 Framework for Action states “to ensure quality education and conditions for effective education outcomes, governments should strengthen education systems by instituting and improving appropriate, effective and inclusive governance and accountability mechanisms; quality assurance; management information systems; transparent and effective financing procedures and mechanisms; and institutional management arrangements, as well as ensure that robust, timely and accessible data are available” (para. 18).

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked):

☐ Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.

☐ Monitoring results are made public. Please provide the link:

<https://www.uzedu.uz/y3/documents/open-data>
<https://stat.uz/uz/rasmiy-statistika/social-protection-2>
<https://www.uzedu.uz/y3/page/6247>

☐ Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.

☐ Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.

☐ Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.

☐ The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.

☐ Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.

☐ There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

The Ministry has implemented a centralized Education Management Information System (EMIS) to track enrollment, attendance, and performance at all levels. This ensures compliance with national and international education standards.

Annual reports and key findings from monitoring processes are published on the Ministry's official website.

Monitoring is conducted in collaboration with local education authorities, school representatives, parents, and civil society organizations.

Quarterly assessments ensure inclusivity and timely feedback.

Governance reforms involve cross-sectoral collaboration with health, finance, and social protection agencies to align education with broader socio-economic goals.

A significant portion of the national budget is allocated to education, with a specific focus on free and inclusive public education.

budget allocations and financial reports are regularly reviewed and shared publicly to ensure accountability.

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Budgetary constraints | ☐ Absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment |
| ☐ Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels | ☐ Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data |
| ☐ Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

For reference: UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked)

- ☐ Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages
- ☐ Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources
- ☐ Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments
- ☐ Other: